

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

THE Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya manifested the *lila* of His birth in Sridham Mayapur on the 23rd day of the month of Falgun in the year 1407 of the Saka Era corresponding to February 1486 A. D. The Lord was born in the evening with the rise of the full-moon which was then in eclipse. Mayapur is situated in the heart of old Navadwip on the eastern bank of the Ganges.* It is now represented by a few isolated mounds that have escaped the destruction that overlook this part of the old town by the shifting of the bed of the river. The summits of these mounds are now crowned by a number of beautiful shrines and other edifices that have been erected within the last fifty years by the piety of the followers of Mahaprabhu. Sridham Mayapur undoubted-

ly constitutes one of the holiest of *tirthas*. Thither flock at all time of the year thousands of pilgrims from all parts for a sight of the birth-site of Mahaprabhu Sri Chaitanya. An ever-growing multitude of devotees join in the devotional functions on the day of the anniversary of the advent of the Lord. Those who have had the good fortune of once visiting the place can never shake off the profound impression that is made on the spirit by the palpable transcendence of this holiest of the holy *tirthas*.

But the eastern part of old Navadwip, although it is now so solitary and rural, was at the time of Mahaprabhu's advent the greatest centre of our ancient culture. It was a vast University town full of the *chatuspathis* of a very large number of the most eminent pundits versed in all branches of Sanskrit learning. The schools of these learned Professors were thronged by an eager crowd of inquisitive students from all parts of the country who found shelter and instruction under their roofs in return for loyal submission to their teachers. These Professors were all of them orthodox Brahmans who were universally respected for their learning, piety and high birth. These particulars are found in contemporary

*The topography of the town of Navadwip of the time of Mahaprabhu is minutely described in several old authentic works of Vaishnava authors. The site is at present identified with the help of the tomb of Chand Kazi, still existing, who was a contemporary of Mahaprabhu and the *fouzdar* of Navadwip under Alauddin Syeed Hussain Shah, independent King of Bengal. A big mound and a spacious tank, neither of them being far from the tomb of Chand Kazi, still bear the historical name of Bullal Sen, the most famous of the Sen Kings of Bengal who removed their capital from Mallah to old Gaudpur Navadwip. The modern town of Navadwip occupying the site of the island of Kulia which was one of the nine islands comprised within 'the city of the nine islands' is situated on the west bank of the river. The name Navadwip came to be applied exclusively to this part of the old city after the latter was practically washed away by the Ganges which in this place has a particularly irregular and shifting course consisting of several different channels.

works from the pens of the followers of Mahaprabhu.

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya made His appearance in a cultured Brahman family of Sri Mayapur. His father Jagannath Misra was a Brahman in the real sense being a gifted scholar deeply versed in the Shastras, profoundly religious in conduct and extremely poor. Mahaprabhu's mother, Sri Sachidevi, was the daughter of Nilambar Chakravarty who was a great astronomer. Jagannath Misra bore the scholar's title of 'Purandar'—Sachidevi gave birth to eight daughters all of whom died in their infancy. Feeling the want of a male child Jagannath Misra worshipped Vishnu to be blessed with a son. Mahasamkarsan of Vaidikuntha was thereby drawn into this world being born as the ninth issue of Purandar Misra and bore the name of Viswarup, the elder brother of Sri Chaitanya.

At Sridham Mayapur in the heart of old Nabadwip—the city of nine islands, on the full moon eve of the month of Falgun—the glorious eve of new spring immemorially consecrated to the swing-pastimes of Sri Krishna—was born Sri Chaitanya Chandra, the spotless Moon of Nabadwip, at Whose advent the spotted moon hid her face in shame under the veil of eclipse. The birth of the Supreme Lord was ushered in by a universal chant of the *sankirtan* of the Name of Hari uttered by all the

people of the great city as is the custom at the time of an eclipse. The Lord was born at the most auspicious moment and in the first ascendant of Leo. His maternal grand father, the great astronomer Nilambar Chakravarti, on calculation discovered all the signs of the *mahapurusha* in the newly born child. The yellow complexion of the infant joined to the extraordinary circumstance that He could be quieted while crying only by the chanting of the Name of Hari led the matrons to name the Boy 'Gaur-Hari,'—and also 'Nimai' for the reason that He was born under a *nim* tree and after the pre-mature end of eight successive daughters.

The minutest details of the incidents of the infancy of the Lord have been preserved with the most loving care by His early biographers. By all accounts Sri Gaur Sundar proved to be a more than ordinarily restless child. His precocity was not less marked. At the ceremony of naming the Baby when diverse objects were held out to Him to ascertain His predilection the Boy astonished everybody by grasping the Srimad Bhagabatam. When He could crawl on His knees the Lord horrified everybody by catching hold of a snake and lying quietly on its coils. As He learnt to walk the Boy by begging from passers-by procured plaintain, sweet-meats, etc. and offered them to those ladies who chanted the Name of Hari. He systematically raided the

ment, by our natural unceasing practice of selfless loving and devotional service.

Sree Radhica is something so subtle and transcendental that she cannot at all be conceived by any man or woman of the material plane nor can she at all be described by human language or by sensuous images. Yet her super-sensuous eternal love is often attempted to be made conceivable to frail and gross human beings when they prove themselves free from fetters of mundane senses arriving at the region of devotional love, otherwise the huge misconception about her true nature and essence prevent to have an access to her eternal services.

Sree Radhica may, however, be considered from at least four different aspects. Let me first of all view her from psychic aspect.

Psychically Sree Radhica is identical with the counterpart of Krishna. The yearnings of love, the joys of unions, the pangs of separation, which are the characteristics of love are all vividly discernible in Sree Radhica for Krishna only whereas we have got a distorted reflection in the human soul. Sree Radhica is indentially the Divine Soul proving herself as the Divine Consort of her lover—the Divine or Universal Soul Krishna.

From the intellectual aspect, Sree Radhica is the centre of all devotional manifestations towards Krishna. Sree

Krishna is often described as singing the name of Sree Radhica through His lute to show His spontaneous affinity towards His Counterpart.

I may also see Sree Radhica from her moral aspect. Morally she is the personification of all tender virtues and super-human attributes. The love, bliss and mercy of Sree Krishna are represented by Sree Radhica. Without Sree Radhica Sree Krishna is a dry cold, philosophic Deity, devoid of accepting services from devotees. As all finite souls are parts of this fountain-head of love, bliss and peace, we, therefore, owe all our serving faculties to Sree Radhica.

Again I may view Sree Radhica from Her physical aspect. Whatever is beautiful in nature is from Sree Radhica. The soft and silvery rays of the autumnal moon, the "sweet south that breathes upon a bank of violets, stealing and giving odour," the fresh and green foliage of the trees and plants clad in the loveliest attire of vernal beauty, the gurgling music of the flowing river, the snow-clad summits of cloud-cleaving mountains, all represent one or other of the several physical emanations of Sree Radhica to interrupt the devotional activities of the enslaved souls.

Sree Radhica is pervertedly represented in our homelife and amidst our domestic scenes. The lovely countenance of the smiling bride, the beauty

and blush of youthful love, the loving tenderness of the affectionate mother, the warmth and zeal of the sincere friend, the charity and kindness of the generous patron all represent the different manifestations of Maya to prevent us from offering service to Krishna.

Thus the true devotees with their soul's eyes can realise the presence of Sree Radhica here, there, and everywhere. Wherever there is love, grace or sweetness in connection with Sree Krishna ignoring all sensuous adventures there is Sree Radhica—wherever there is any manifestation of bliss or joy arising from Krishna's love there is Sree Radhica. Indeed, Sree Radhica is love or bliss incarnate of Krishna. She truly represents the loving and blissful aspects of Sree Krishna.

By the constant offering of true services to Sree Radhica, the devotee rises above the sordid atmosphere of this sinful and sorrowful world and lives in a region "where all liberated souls serve Krishna incessantly and uninterruptedly"

Sing, therefore, the glory of Sree Radhica night and day, and if you are ambitious enough to be blessed with the lotus feet of Sree Krishna, try to approach that Lord, only through His beloved Sree Radhica's grace for she is the path, way and end of all aspiration of a devotee.

[BISWESWAR DAS, B. A., SANTIPUR]

[The article has been thoroughly recast in the spirit of a true Chaitanya. It for which the writer may be pleased to excuse us.—E. H.]

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 237, March, 1928.)

ON a certain day He ate up several times the cooked rice of a pilgrim Brahman who happened to be a guest at the house while the latter was absorbed in meditation in the act of offering it to Sri Krishna. On another day the Lord was stolen by two thieves who attempted to rob the ornaments

worn by the Child but was brought back to His father's house by those very thieves through a curious mistake on their part. He induced His father to fetch the offering to Sri Krishna prepared on the *Ekadasi* day at the house of Pundits Jagadish and Hiranya which was two miles distant from the house

of Misra, although, by reason of the distance, a boy of His tender age could have ordinarily no means of knowing what was going on at the Pundits' house.

He played many a prank on little girls. He would forcibly take away their flowers, garlands, sandal-paste and offerings accepting those Himself. He used to tell them that Ganga and Durga were His maid-servants and Siva His servant.

He was often angry, broke everything in the house and beat His mother. When one day Sachi Devi had fainted away He procured cocoanuts, scarce in that season, to aid her recovery. Viswarup, the elder brother of Goursundar, who was deeply versed in all the shastras cultivated constant association with the Vaishnavas whose meeting-place was the house of Advaita and was so unmindful of everything else that he had to be fetched home for his meals. Sri Gaurisundar often went up to the *tol* of Advaitacharyya on this errand when all present would be invariably struck with His extraordinary beauty. After Viswarup renounced the world and became a *sannyasin* Nimai became restrained in His conduct and devoted Himself wholly to His studies. Deeply shocked by the *sannyas* of Viswarup Jagannath Misra was frightened by this sudden change in Nimai and altogether stopped His studies. This made the Boy more turbulent than ever. One day He seated Himself on

the top of a pile of discarded, used up cooking pots which are regarded as unclean by the *smarta* Brahmins, and, when his mother asked Him to come away from that foul place maintained that the earthen pots having been used in cooking offerings for Vishnu can never be unclean and the spot where God Himself is seated is the meeting place of all the holy *tirthas*.

The *upanayana* ceremony of Nimai was duly performed and the Boy was sent to the *chatuspathi* of the great teacher Gangadas Pundit of Ganganagar very close to Sri Mayapur quarters to study Sanskrit Grammar. The extraordinary intelligence of the Boy astonished and baffled everybody. Nimai persuaded His mother, by falling at her feet, to give up eating cooked rice on the *Bhadra* day. Jagannath Misra was upset by being apprized in a dream of the future *sannyas* of Nimai and shortly afterwards left the world. Nimai consoled His mother with great tenderness. But He continued to be unreasonable in His demands to His mother and was often angry. One day on learning that there was no money in the house He procured from somewhere two tolas of gold and gave it to her.

Sri Gaur Narayan now entered upon the *lila* of a house-holder's life. Sri Banamali Ghatak proposed to Sachi Devi the marriage of Sri Gaurisundar with Lakshmi Devi, the daughter of Ballavacharyya. On an auspicious day

and in an auspicious moment the nuptial ceremony, laden with every blessing of Gaur and Lakshmi was duly consummated.

Sri Isvara-puri, the disciple of Sri Madhabendra-puri at this time arrived at Navadvip and stayed as guest at the house of Advaita Prabhu. Meeting him on the way Gaur-sundar invited him to meal at His house. One day Sri Isvara-puri asked Mahaprabhu to correct the errors of 'Sri Krishna-lila-mrita' a work composed by Puri himself. Mahaprabhu declined to do this giving as His reason that there can be no defect in the inspired writings or utterances of the Gurudeva and the Vaishnavas belonging to the *srauta* school and that those persons who, actuated by pride of worldly knowledge point out any defects in their words or writings undoubtedly belong to the class of '*pasandis*'.

It was at this time that Sri Gaur-sundar manifested the love of God in the guise of nervous malady.

Mahaprabhu showered His mercy on all by accepting the offerings of weavers, cow-herds, grocers, garland-makers, betel sellers, conch dealers and the other people resident in the town, presenting Himself at their houses. Mahaprabhu in this manner visited an astrologer in the latter's house and asked him to calculate His previous birth. Where-upon as the latter, having repeated the *mantra* of Gopal, engaged

in the calculation he had forthwith the beatific vision of the four-armed and two-armed Forms of the Divinity. Mahaprabhu also visited the house of Sridhar who sold small pieces of the plantain-bark being called 'plantain-bark seller Sridhar.' On this occasion Mahaprabhu made Sridhar promise Him a free supply of the core, bark and fruit of the plantain, radishes etc. from his garden.

During this period Mahaprabhu became renowned as the leading Professor of Navadvip. He defeated in controversy a certain famous Pundit who had acquired the title of 'Conqueror of all quarters' (दिग्विजयी) by his victories in learned contests over the scholars of all parts. The goddess of worldly learning whom the vanquished conquering Pundit worshipped, disclosing in a dream the cause of his discomfiture on this occasion, told her votary that she herself has not the power of confronting Narayana and advised him to make his submission to Gaur-Narayana without delay. Thus enlightened the defeated Pundit in the early dawn next day hastened to Mahaprabhu and having made his submission informed Him of what had happened. Mahaprabhu instructed the fortunate Pundit in the service of Krishna and enabled him to realise that the service of Vishnu and Vaishnavas is the goal of all learning. The disciple of this defeated savant Ganguly Bhatta had a disciple after.

wards named Keshab Bhatta of Kashmere who is alleged to have figured well and revived the Modern Nimbarka school according to Mahaprabhu's views of worship.

The great professor Nimai Pundit now went out on a peripatetic tour in Eastern Bengal ostensibly for the purpose of earning money by teaching pupils, and established everywhere the *samkirtan* of the holy Name. The fame of His great learning soon attracted hundreds of scholars to His feet. At this time a Brahman named Tapan Misra, directed by a dream, came to Mahaprabhu to obtain from Him the solution of his doubts regarding spiritual method and object having become perplexed by the conflicting interpretations of different *munis* (mentalists). The Lord told him that the *samkirtan* of the Name of Hari is the only method as well as the object and also commanded him to proceed to Benares.

On His return from East Bengal He was informed of the departure of Lakshmi Devi to Baikuntha Dhama. The manifested grief after the manner of mortals suited to the occasion and instructed His mother about the transitoriness of the worldly sojourn.

Whenever Mahaprabhu detected any of His pupils without the *tilaka* mark the very first thing He did was to send the student back to his home to attend to *tilaka* observing that the forehead

unmarked with the *tilaka* sign is like the charnel ground.

The *lila* of the marriage of Mahaprabhu with Sri Vishnupriya Devi, the Daughter of the Rajpundit Sri Sanatan Misra who also resided at Navadvip, was celebrated on an auspicious day and in an auspicious moment. A most fortunate person, Buddhimanta Khan, as the fruit of many good deeds performed by him, undertook voluntarily to bear all the expenses of this *lila* of the marriage of Lakshmi and Narayana.

Gaursundar drank the washing of the feet of Brahmans during His illness after the manner of elevationists who are the seekers of the fruits of their works. He made His way to Gaya where He offered *pinda* and visited the lotus feet of Gadadhar. It was here that He met Sri Isvara-puri and submitted to be his disciple receiving from him the ten-lettered *mantram*. Everyone of these acts have a deep significance.

At last the time of manifesting Himself arrived. After His return from Gaya Mahaprabhu's mood underwent a complete change. The restlessness, the arrogance and pride of the great scholar, the turbulence, of the past suddenly disappeared. Attempting to communicate in strictest privacy to a few select devotees the happenings at Gaya He was drenched in a torrent of tears continuing to repeat the Name of Krishna. He was found frequently to

shiver, to sigh incessantly and utter no words except those about Krishna. He explained to His pupils, as the meaning of every passage of text, commentary and annotation, the Name of Krishna telling all persons that in the whole of the *shastras* there is no other word except the Name of Krishna. Once, after the manner of Kapila, He described to Sachi Devi the sorrows of the *jiva* during confinement within the mother's womb and instructed her as to the advisability of constantly taking the Name of Krishna in the company of *sadhus*. When His pupils ask Him the meaning of 'dhatu' (धातु) 'the verbal root' the Lord explains that the verbal root is the power of Krishna. The Lord commands His pupils to listen to and chant constantly the Name of Krishna giving up all other endeavours and Himself teaches them *samkirtan*.

In order to teach people to serve the Vaishnavas He performs with His own hands humble menial work for the Vaishnavas. Sometimes He receives on His head the dust of the feet of the devotees and their blessings proclaiming that the service of Krishna can only be gained through the mercy of of the Vaishnavas.

One day, seated on the couch of Vishnu, the Lord declared that Sachi Devi had offended against Sri Advaita Acharyya, and, for that reason not till her offence against a Vaishnava was pardoned would she attain the loving

devotion of God. Sri Sachi Devi, under the influence of pure maternal affection, had attributed the *sannyas* of Visvarup to the prompting of Advaitacharyya. Thereupon, as the devotees fetched Advaita Prabhu to the spot the latter began to dilate on the great qualities of the 'Mother' (माइ) and soon lapsed into the exclusive mood of loving devotion. Availing of this opportunity Sachi Devi begged for and obtained his pardon receiving on her head the dust of the feet of Sri Advaitacharyya. By this act Mahaprabhu made it perfectly clear that no one can attain loving devotion to God if his offence against the Vaishnavas remains un-pardoned.

Being entreated by Advaitacharyya Mahaprabhu showed him the Cosmic Form of the Krishna-*lila* in the courtyard of Sribash's house. On another occasion the devotees met together in the house of Sribash and performed the installation ceremony of Mahaprabhu. The Lord, seated on the couch of Vishnu, made manifest His majesty as Supreme Ruler. Mahaprabhu, on this occasion, freely gave away whatever boon was desired by any supplicants.

Mahaprabhu sent for Nityananda who was at this time staying in seclusion at the house of Nandan Acharyya. Sri Nityananda, the prime representative of the Supreme Lord, the same as the son of Rohini, made his appearance at the house of Hadai Pandit from the womb of Padmavati at the village of

Ekchaka in the District of Birbhum. A Vaishnava *sannyasin* Lakshmipati Tirtha begged for Nityananda from his father and took him away when he was a child. From that time Nityananda travelled to many countries in the company of the *sannyasin* and resided for a long time in the region of Mathura from where he was drawn to Navadwip by Mahaprabhu. Mahaprabhu now employed Thakur Haridas and Prabhu Nityananda in preaching the Name of Krishna to each and every household over the whole of Navadwip.

One day as Prabhu Nityananda having preached the Name from door to door was returning at night-fall to Mahaprabhu's residence he fell in with two drunkards, Jagai and Madhai. These two persons, born in a hereditary Brahman family, were engaged in all possible forms of sinful acts in the shape of drinking, eating beef, robbery, adultery etc. But as they spent their whole time in the society of drunkards these two worthless Brahmans had yet had no opportunity of committing the offence of maligning the Vaishnavas. Nityananda, full of boundless sympathy for the sufferings of others, the Saviour of the fallen, and Thakur Haridas made up their minds to bestow their grace

on Jagai and Madhai. It was as if for the purpose of showing them his favour that Prabhu Nityananda was out that night. Jagai and Madhai met Prabhu Nityananda. No sooner did he hear the name '*abadhuta*' 'super-ascetic', maddened with anger, Madhai struck a blow with his strong fist on the head of Prabhu Nityananda. Noticing this Jagai tried to prevent Madhai from persisting in such offence. At this moment Mahaprabhu Himself with His associates and followers appeared on the spot and in His anger summoned the *Sudarsan chakra* whereupon Nityananda said to Mahaprabhu that Jagai defended him, and therefore, it was necessary to pardon him. Mahaprabhu was propitiated towards Jagai. At this the mind of Madhai also was changed. Nityananda Prabhu pardoned Madhai. Both of them being deeply repentent and having promised never again in life to do any other thing except service of Krishna Mahaprabhu and the devotees were moved to be merciful to them. By the mercy of Mahaprabhu even those two robbers become eminent Vaishnavas. Mahaprabhu commanded His followers not to show any disrespect for them in future remembering their past sinful deeds.

(To be continued).

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 248, April, 1928.)

BY holding before the town of Nadia, the home of countless high-born Brahmans, the ideals of the preaching of the holy Name of God by Thakur Haridas born in a Muhammadan family and of the deliverance of Jagai and Madhai by Nityananda Mahaprabhu made it clear that the Vaishnava Acharyya (teacher of the religion that he practises) is not to be judged by his family or caste but is a supermundane being who is the teacher of the whole world and that there is forgiveness for all other offences but that God Himself does not pardon the offence that is committed against a Vaishnava. Nityananda Prabhu and Sri Gaur Sundar are only kind to one who is free from offence against the Vaishnavas.

Mahaprabhu now began to perform the *kirtan* in the company of His associates and followers every night without a break in Sribash Pandit's house with closed doors. Un-Godly persons failing to obtain the privilege of admission into these devotional gatherings tried in various ways to humiliate Sribash Pandit. A certain person of the name of 'Gopal Chapal', mis-called Brahman, once deposit opposite the closed entrance of the house of Sribash Pandit articles used in the worship of the Devi includ-

ing liquor-pots. He was smitten with virulent leprosy for this offence against the Vaishnavas. In the agony of his un-hearable sufferings 'Gopal Chapal' approached Mahaprabhu and piteously implored His forgiveness. But considering the gravity of his offence Mahaprabhu did not pardon him at that time. But when after His *sannyas* Mahaprabhu was staying at Kulia on His return from Puri Gopal Chapal again sought His protection. This time Mahaprabhu advised him to seek the favour of Sribash Pandit. By the grace of Sribash 'Gopal Chapal' was absolved from his offence.

Mahaprabhu also established the ideal of performing the *kirtan* of Hari in the company of Godly persons who alone are fit to join in such function. One night Mahaprabhu with His devotees began the *sankirtan* in Sribash's house having had the gates closed and forbidden the admission of unfit persons. The mother-in-law of Sribash happened to be in hiding inside the house. Mahaprabhu as knower of all hearts was aware of this and complained that He felt obstructed in proceeding with the *kirtan* with sufficient zeal. Sribash Pandit judged by this that some atheist must have found his way into the

house and hidden himself somewhere. He accordingly at once began an elaborate search and detected his own mother-in-law stowed away in a corner. Sribash Pandit directed her to be dragged out by the hair.

On another occasion when it happened to be a full-moon night Nityananda prepared for the worship of Vyasadeva by command of Mahaprabhu. Sribash became the Acharyya at this worship. As Sri Nityananda Prabhu in the act of chanting the *kirtan* placed garlands of flowers round the neck of Mahaprabhu Sri Gour Sundar manifested to him His six-armed Form.

In this manner Mahaprabhu continued to display various manifestations of His Divine Power. Sri Pundarik Vidyānidhi, the foremost among the Paramahansa Vaishnavas, who was an inhabitant of Chattagram joined Mahaprabhu at Nabadwip at this time. One day Mahaprabhu seated Himself on the couch of Vishnu in the house of Sribash and manifested His Divine Power in a most wonderful way. This marvellous mood lasted for seven *praharas* (twenty one hours) and is known as 'the mood of the seven *praharas*' and also as the great Manifestation.' It was during the continuance of this mood that Mahaprabhu bestowed the name of the happy' (*sukhi*) in place of her old name 'the unhappy' (*dukhi*) on a maid servant of Sribash who used to fetch water for

Him. He also declared the greatness of Sridhar. The Lord showered His favours on Haridas. Sri Mukunda was staying outside all this time. After the Lord had bestowed His favour on all the devotees singly He was informed that Mukunda was outside. The Lord thereupon said, 'I will not be soon propitiated towards Mukunda. He speaks the language of pure devotion to the devotees. But when he is with the *mayavadins* (illusionists) he professes the doctrine of *maya* as, expounded in the Yoga-Vashistha. On Mukunda intimating his firm resolve to give up all association with the illusionists thenceforward the Lord commanded him immediately to His presence and expressed His satisfaction at his conduct. By this act of his the Lord made it known that the so-called latitudinarians or liberals who are disposed to tolerate all opinions have no chance of obtaining the grace of God until they exclusively practise pure devotion with a firm faith which is free from the least taint of any predilections for any other opinions e.g. empiricism, utilitarianism etc. by discarding all evil association.

Sri Advaitacharyya was the co-disciple of Sri Isvarapuri who appears in the role of the Guru of Sree Chaitanya-deva the Supreme Guru of the whole world. For this reason the Supreme Lord shewed Sree Advaitacharyya all the respect that is due to the Spiritual

Preceptor. Sri Advaitacharyya was surely grieved at this. He repaired to Santipur and there began to expound the excellence of the path of empiric knowledge to certain ill-fated people who deserved to be so deceived with the deliberate object of provoking the Supreme grace of the Lord's chastisement. Mahaprabhu on hearing of what Advaita was doing was filled with great indignation. He at once made His way to Santipur and administered with His own hands a severe cudgelling to Sri Advaita Prabhu. While he was being thus thrashed Sri Advaita Prabhu danced with joy crying, 'Today the wish of my heart is fulfilled.'

One day as the Supreme Lord expatiated on the glories of the Holy Name of His followers declaring that there was nothing equal or superior to It a certain luck-less student happened to protest saying that the glories of the Name that had been declared by the Lord could not be true but were mere eulogy. The Lord forbade His devotees to see the face of that student who thus offended against the Name and attired as He was forthwith made His way to the Ganges and bathed in its water with all His associates to be absolved of the sin of having listened to such blasphemy.

One day the Lord appeared to be fatigued by His exertions at a proces-

sional *kirtan* which He was leading along the streets. Arrived in the court-yard of one of His devotees the Lord sowed into the ground the stone of the mango-fruit and immediately it grew into a great branching tree with ripe fruitage. A great mango festivity was thereupon celebrated with those fruits. That spot is famous to this day and still bears the name of 'Am-hatta' (Amghata) 'the mango fair.'

Another day as the Lord was performing *samkirtan* at a place that was at some distance from human habitation the sky was overcast with clouds. The Lord commanded the clouds to depart whereupon they immediately disappeared. For this reason the people used to call that sandy bank of the Ganges 'the sand-bank of the clouds.' On a certain day the Lord, imbued with the disposition of Baladeva manifesting the *lila* of drawing of the Jamuna, with a loud voice ordered for wine. On this occasion Chandrasekhar Acharyya, Banamali Acharyya and certain other devotees behold in the hand of the Lord the golden club.

When the Lord began to preach the Name He commanded those who lived in the neighbourhood of the court-yard of Sribash to chant the Name of Hari with clap of hand. By degrees the *samkirtan* was proclaimed at the door of every house of Nabadwip with the music of *mridanga*, cymbal and other

instruments. Hinduism had been greatly in abeyance at Nabadwip ever since its occupation by Bakhtiyar Khilji. It was the same in the time of Mahaprabhu under the regime of its military governor, Chand Kazi. In fact the Hindus of Nabadwip did not venture to utter the Name of God for fear of the Muhammadans. But now by command of the Supreme Lord the *kirtan* of the Name of Hari began to be chanted in a loud key to the accompaniment of *mridanga* and cymbal in every house of Nabadwip. Hearing of this Chand Kazi proceeded to the house of

one of the townspeople who lived close to the court-yard of Sribash at Sri Mayapur and as he was guilty of chanting the *kirtan* broke his *mridanga* and proclaimed his resolve to punish with great severity and with loss of caste any resident of the town who chanted *kirtan* in the manner taught by Sri Gaur Sundar. The spot where Chand Kazi broke the '*khol*' of the citizen became famous from that time and came to be called by the name of '*khol bhangar danga*' the mound where the *khol* was broken and still maintains its old name. (To be continued.)

Taking Refuge in God (श्रीशरणागति)

(Continued from P. 250, April, 1928.)

[XVII]

1. I do not know by what power impelled
Thy abode I seek for refuge
Full of mercy, Purifier of sinners,
Thou art ever bent on the deliverance of the fallen.
2. My only hope, O Lord, is this
That Thou surely art kind,
There is not another who needs Thy mercy more than myself,
Thou wilt surely drive away all my fear.
3. No one in all the world
Has the power to deliver me
Cherished Lord, full of mercy, by Thy declaration
Save the basest of sinners.

proportion as such organisation is perfected, is bound to embody this general principle with greater fulness and clearness. When the ideal of democracy has been realised only such proposals as carry in them any prospect of the gratification of the senses of its members will receive the 'active' support of such community. This true psychology of the masses is exploited *deliberately by all successful public men for their own private sensuous gratification.* This is the truth regarding the philosophy of the lifeless numerical or democratic principle. It is the virus carried from the source pollution to other parts of the body by the fly that gloats over the process.

The force of the above observations is not lessened by the enumeration of the names of all the distinguished persons that are ordinarily paraded in the forefront of such proposals to furnish such foreign aristocratic support to an insubstantial structure. But these distinguished men would lose their distinction the very moment they proved untrue to their salt. They have gained their distinction by success in pandering to the sensuous gratification of their bretheren. How else can such people be grateful to them? Let us take a very ambiguous looking case *viz.* that of a person who has attained distinction by scientific research but refused all titles and riches for himself. His discovery is appreciated by the people because it either directly provides them with a new means of sensuous gratification or does so indirectly by the prevention or amelioration of worldly misery either physical or mental. He himself seeks the satisfactions of being the benefactor of mankind by helping them in thus gratifying their senses, the satisfaction in his case taking the mental form based on the sensuous. All real analysis brings us by the pitiless force of impartial logic to the *economic value* which governs the whole physical and mental world. The tangibility and strength of the modern European civilization consist in its clear realization and un-flinching pursuit of this

ideal. Modern philanthropy is the impulse, prompted by the reaction of sentimental and the pre-science of calculating selfishness for the dissemination of the direct and indirect means for the sensuous gratification of the largest number of men and women who may not possess a sufficiency of it. Such philanthropy alone, such science alone, can expect the active support of a community composed of individuals who want nothing else except of the means of gratification of their senses.

Religion is used similarly by those who really want to catch the popular applause. What such persons have to prove is that all the benefits promised by religion are nothing but a stronger and an eternal foundation on which the most permanent structure of sensuous gratification, to which the other sciences cater so imperfectly, can be most successfully reared. If you want social or political or any sort worldly betterment all you have to do is to betake yourself to religion and the thing will be automatically secured. It will give you *all* those things *that you desire.* "Believe implicitly in this. Look at me. Have I not been successful in making the two ends meet? Follow, *therefore*, my example." Have those preachers of the religion ever looked "a certain measure" of popular support in any age or century? Should such support be considered *therefore*, as the conclusive proof of the truth of their professions?

Now look at another picture. It is a matter of historical knowledge that the crucifixion of Jesus Christ was demanded by public opinion to which the weak-kneed Pilate succumbed against his own convictions. Muhammad was ferociously persecuted by the public of his day. Sri Chaitanya avoided the determined persecution of the elite of the most cultured city of that age by renunciation of home and society and by a voluntary exile. And this is true of all other preachers of the true religion. All of them instead of having any public support in this

day were objects of special public detestation. The subsequent reaction of public opinion in their favour was equally deceptive and brought about by persons who exploited their sufferings for winning public fame for themselves by presenting in the name of the martyrs an attenuated form of the true religion which could be recognised as helpful to the worldly ambitions of the generality of the people.

The mass is never likely to be converted to the true faith. Such conversion is a strictly individual affair. Real converts to the true faith have always been extraordinarily few and none of them found it possible to mix with the people of this world on terms of real intimacy because their tastes and aspirations were an uncompromising denial of all economic values which form the one basis on which is founded the discordant hypocritical unity of the civilized communities of every age which are more savage in reality than the unlettered barbarians who possess no covering for their naked bodies and whose frank animalism has no artistic or philosophic apertures or watchdogs of the

'liberty' of the un-restrained pursuit of sensuous gratification in the form of the fourth estate of the realm of Pluto, *viz.* the modern newspaper.

One cannot serve both God and mammon. It is only those who seek the real Truth for its own sake that can have any 'active' sympathy for those who 'serve Krishna by giving up all sensuous desire for the objects of this world in obedience to the command of the holy Scriptures and by so doing are relieved from every other form of obligation either to the gods, the *rishis* or the *pitris* that is to say the so-called ordinary 'obligations' of the society that only lives unto itself. All these worldly obligations they have to forego because they stand directly in the way of serving the real Truth which is no other than God Himself. And God, the Absolute Truth, rewards them by bestowing on them not any of those things that men of this world covet because all those have no charm for them, but—Himself, by submitting to be won by their really unselfish devotion to Himself for the sake of Himself.

Pro Bono Publico.

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 279, May, 1928.)

WHEN Sri Chaitanya came to learn from the lips of the towns-people, who were in a great dismay about the occurrence of the *khol* being broken, He became indignant and told them to continue the *kirtan* in every house with full vigour. But as the people were very much afraid of the proclamation of the Kazi He decided to lead a processional *kirtan* of all the citizens to the

door of the Kazi's house to reassure the people. Three huge *kirtan*-processions of all the citizens, each of whom carried two lighted torches, were accordingly formed on that ever memorable evening and made their way to the residence of the Kazi, who hid himself inside his house on its approach. But the people made the Kazi come out. Whereupon Sri Chaitanya had a long conversation

with the Kazi on the subject of the practice of Islamic religion. The Kazi was silenced by the argument of Sri Chaitanya and admitted the insufficiency of the scriptures on which he had relied. He further confessed to Sri Chaitanya that he had been put into a great fear by a series of most extraordinary occurrences. After he had returned from the house of the citizen, whose '*khol*' he caused to be broken, in the night he was all but killed by a most terrible form with human body and the face of a lion which sprang upon him and grinding its teeth threatened to tear up his heart and kill his whole family for his offence of having broken the *mridanga*. The Kazi showed Sri Chaitanya the very marks of the lion's paw on his breast in corroboration of his statement. He also described the experience of the peon whom he had sent to forbid *kirtan*. That man complained that his face was struck by a meteor-like substance which burnt his beard and scarred his cheeks. The man also reported that from the moment that he had told the Hindus that they should not shout 'Hari, Hari', as the words meant 'I steal, I steal' and it would prove their purpose of stealing other people's property, his lips had been automatically uttering 'Hari, Hari' against his own inclination. The Kazi also said that complaints had been made to him by a number of Hindus charging Sri Chaitanya with practices that were new

and contrary to their religion and likely to destroy it if they were not stopped; that the loud *kirtan* in and out of season broke the peace of the town and prevented their sleep; that it was against their religion to utter with a loud voice the *mantra* of the Name of God; that, therefore, as ruler of the place, the Kazi should order Sri Chaitanya to leave the town. Sri Chaitanya was delighted on hearing the words 'Hari', 'Krishna', 'Narayan' from the mouth of the Kazi and told him that all his ills had left him as he had uttered those holy Names of God. The Kazi then touched the feet of Sri Chaitanya and prayed for devotion to His feet. Sri Chaitanya then begged this *as alms* from the Kazi that there might be no further molestation of *kirtan* at Navadwip. The Kazi promised that he would leave an order to his family and descendants that none of them must offer any opposition to *kirtan* at any time in the future. Even to this day at Sri Mayapur on the occasion of the annual perambulation of *Sridham* the descendants of the Kazi have always willingly joined in the *kirtan* of Krishna.

One night while Sri Chaitanya was chanting the *kirtan* of Hari with his companions in the yard of Sribash, a son of Sribash chanced to breathe his last. Sribash ordered the females of the house not to make any noise or other demonstration of their grief as it might interfere with the joy of Sri

Chaitanya in the chanting of *kirtan*. After the *kirtan* was finished Sri Chaitanya learnt of what had happened and expressed His regret that the news of it had been kept from Him for such a long time. He then made the dead child tell the bereaved family the truth regarding what had happened to him and this relieved them of all grief on his account. Sri Chaitanya said to Sribash, 'The son that was once yours has left you ; but Myself and Nityananda are your eternal Sons. We can never leave you'.

A certain tailor who lived close to Sribash's house and sewed the clothes of Sribash was charmed by witnessing with faith the dance of Sri Chaitanya. Thereupon the Lord showed that fortunate tailor His own Form ; the tailor smitten with holy love at once began to dance crying 'I have seen, I have seen'.

One night the Lord took part in a dramatic exhibition of certain sacred episodes at the house of Chandra-Sekhar Acharyya. Sri Chaitanya Himself appeared in the garb of Rukmini, and Sri Advaita, Sri Nityananda, Sribash, Sri Haridas and other devotees put on dresses in keeping with other parts. This was the first theatrical performance staged in Bengal. Sri Chaitanya Math, the source of the numerous Maths that are the centers of propaganda of the movement of un-alloyed devotion in the present age, stands on

the site of the house of Chandra-Sekhar Acharyya.

One day a Brahman woman having touched the feet of the Lord on the conclusion of *kirtan*, Sri Chaitanya, as Teacher of the world, in order to warn those so-called *Sahajiyas* who follow sensuous inclinations, threw Himself into the Ganges to do away with His body for allowing itself to be touched by a woman, but was rescued by the exertions of Nityananda, Haridas and other devotees.

On a certain day as Sri Goursundar, the embodiment of grief at separation from Krishna, was articulating the word 'gopi' with a heart broken with the pang of separation, a student, a scoffer of God, happened by accident to come to the presence of the Lord and intruded with the remark, 'Why are you repeating in vain the word 'gopi' which is the name of a woman, instead of taking the Name of Krishna ? The Lord hearing this began to blame Krishna in the mood of the gopi. The luckless student showing no disposition to catch the sense of His words the Lord, in His exclusive mood, as milkmaid of Braja, taking the student to be a partisan of Krishna, ran after him stick in hand with an appearance of anger threatening to beat him. The student fled outright. On hearing of this the so-called Brahmans, addicted to mechanical ceremonials for gaining worldly ends and wholly averse to God,

in their infatuation, began to conspire for beating the Lord Himself. In order to reclaim those professors, students, religionists, elevationists, ascetics and other impious persons from the offence of their inveterate hostility against Vishnu and Vaishnavas, the Lord now wished to accept the fourth *asrama*, that of *sannyas*, which in the estimation of the society of those worldly people conferred on a *sannyasin* the status of the teacher of even those who were proud of being the possessors of the highest *varna* and social position. If He accepted *sannyas* all would, therefore, bow to Him as a *sannyasin*. By such deference to Him even those Brahmans who vilified Him might be aroused to the impropriety of such conduct. Having formed this decision, on the last day of the north-ward course of the sun of the bright fortnight of the month of Magh, in the closing hours of the wintry night, Sri Chaitanya, having just completed the twenty-fourth year of His pastimes, left the home of His father and having swum the Ganges at the point that has since been called the 'unkind-bathing ghat' (*nidayar ghat*), arrived at Katwa.

There Sri Chaitanya showed His mercy to Keshav Bharati under the guise of receiving back the same *mantra* of *sannyas* from him which He Himself first spoke into his ear, and also received the staff of *sannyas*. Inspired by Sri Chaitanya Keshav Bharati declared 'Sri Krishna Chaitanya' as the Name which the Lord was to bear thence-forward as a *sannyasin*. The explanation that Bharati offered for his choice of the Name was that Sri Chaitanya would arouse the spiritual consciousness of the inert world by the *kirtan* of Krishna. By the desire of Sri Chaitanya Chandra Sekhar Acharyya performed, on His behalf, the necessary rites that had to be gone through on the occasion. The shaving of the head was finished amidst the cries of His devotees towards the close of a day which had been spent in constant *kirtan*. On the next day Sri Krishna Chaitanya started on his wanderings in *Rahr* chanting all the way the song in quest of the Infinite that has such a strange power of inclining the hearer to the paths of devotion, of the mendicant of Avanti, which we find in the Bhagabat. (To be continued.)

abyss of the deadly ocean of intangible abstraction. Numberless men and women hailed as religion and liberalism such temporary excitement for the commission of useless suicide. Another class of people caught in the murderous jaws of the demoness of foreign culture, manners and customs and bad system of education, set themselves to improvise a variety of novel creeds. Under the dominating influence of this imported impulse a few raised the cry of a new latitudinarianism; some proclaimed the character of Krishna as the type of obscenity; some judged Mahaprabhu as having been guilty of transgressing against the law of duty and even considered that He was of an unsound mind; while others out of pity condescended to recognise Mahaprabhu as having possessed a personality that would certainly mark Him out as a *man* among ten of the people of this world. Some refused to bestow their serious consideration on the Vaishnava religion regarding it as the glorification of senti-

mentality, stupidity and immorality. There were found persons who declared the Vaishnava religion to be the worship of man, idolatry or even as the worship of the Devil. Some proved Vaisnavism to be the perversion either of Buddhism or of the Samkhya philosophy. Some affected to view it as a petty creed, limited to an exclusive body of people, made by small persons,—under the impression that the ordinary activities of the mind and the body constitute the eternal and universal religion. Some actually tried to strangle to death the religion of the Vaishnavas imagining that the Vaishnava religion which professes the reality of the supreme spiritual harmony was opposed to the principle of comprehension and to *varnasrama dharma*. It was while this darkness brooded over the realm of Gauda that Thakur Sri Bhaktivinode set to work to terminate this long night of terrible gloom and inaugurate a white auspicious dawn in the circle of Navadvip. *(To be continued.)*

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 14, June, 1928.)

AFTER wandering about the country in this exclusive mood for three days Sri Krishna-Chaitanya now a *sannyasi* came in sight of the Ganges opposite Santipur having been conducted thither by the clever management of

Prabhu Nityananda. On beholding the Ganges Sri Chaitanya took the river to be the Yamuna and accordingly recited a hymn of praise to Yamuna and supposed that He was in the neighbourhood of Sri Brindaban. Sri Advaita

Prabhu now crossed over from Santipur in a boat in order to convey Sri Chaitanya to his house. The sight of Advaita recalled Sri Chaitanya to external consciousness and He was induced to accompany Sri Advaita Prabhu to his Santipur residence. Sri Advaita Prabhu made Seeta Devi prepare a great variety of eatables and offered them first to Sri Gaursundar and Sri Nityananda. Sri Chaitanya asked Sri Haridas and Sri Mukunda to sit at meal with Himself but they preferred to take their meal after Sri Chaitanya had finished eating. Sri Advaita Prabhu along with Sri Haridas and Sri Mukunda then partook of the portion of the meal that remained in the dish after it had been tasted by Sri Gaursundar.

The entire population of Santipur began to pour in a continuous stream to obtain a sight of the holy feet of Sri Chaitanya. There was *samkirtan* with dancing in the evening when Sri Chaitanya manifested simultaneously the eight *sattwic* perturbations as Mukunda began the *kirtan*. His mother, Sri Sachi Devi, arrived in a *dola* the next morning with a very large number of devotees from Navadwip. Sachi Devi had thus an opportunity of seeing her Son once again. Sri Chaitanya stopped for ten days at the house of Advaita. While there He consoled Sachi Devi, performed *kirtan* in the company of the devotees of Navadwip and accepted daily the food that was cooked by Sachi

Devi with her own hands. In order to teach them the conduct that is proper for a *sannyasi* Sri Chaitanya told the people of Navadwip that it was not the duty of one after acceptance of *sannyas* to stay in his native place amidst his friends and relatives. Mother Sachi on hearing of this judged it to be proper that Sri Gaursundar must do what He considered to be His duty and accordingly asked Him to reside at Nilachal (Puri). Sri Chaitanya then took leave of the devotees of Navadwip and of His mother and asked them to devote all the time of their lives to the holy Name of Krishna and Krishna-talk.

Sri Chaitanya started on His journey to Sri Purusottam (Puri), by the road that led past Chhatrabhog in the company of Nityananda, Mukunda, Jagadananda and Damodar. After visiting Briddhamantreswar Sree Krishna Chaitanya crossed the frontiers into the kingdom of Utkal. The party moved on along the road to Puri, Sri Chaitanya chanting joyously the *kirtan* of Krishna with His associates, obtaining their food by begging in the wayside villages. Journeying in this manner Sri Chaitanya reached the village of Remuna where He beheld Sri Gopinath and narrated to His devotees the story of Madhabendra Puri and *Ksheer-chora* (stealer of a sweet-preparation of milk) Gopinath as told to Himself by Sri Iswara Puri. The Lord exhibited the

state of delirium under the anxieties of separation from the Beloved on reciting the *sloka* of Madhabendra Puri 'अयि दीन दयार्द्रनाथ !' He stopped for that night at Remuna and resumed the journey to Puri the next morning.

Sri Chaitanya arrived at the town of Cuttack by way of Jajpur. At Cuttack He saw Sri Sakshi Gopal and listened to the story of Gopal from the mouth of Sri Nityananda. From Cuttack He proceeded to Bhubaneswar and there saw the God Siva, the protecting Deity of the holy realm of Sri Jagannath Deva. After this the Lord paid a flying visit to Kamalpur on the Bhargi to have a sight of Kapoteswara Siva. It was while He went up into the shrine leaving His ascetic's staff in the keeping of Nityananda that the latter deliberately broke it into three pieces and threw them into the Bhargi. By this act Sri Nityananda made it known that it was not necessary for God Himself to carry the staff or other symbols of regulation of oneself in as much God is His own Master. Sri Chaitanya was angry at this to warn against misunderstanding of the action of Nityananda. Because although it is not necessary for God or even a *paramahansa* Vaishnava to submit to any penal regulation there was not the least chance of well-being for the novice on the

path of spiritual effort who was still subject to worldly impulses if such a person chose to act in such free manner in lieu of submitting the mind, body and speech to the strictest penal regulations.

When Sri Chaitanya reached the *Atharanal* (the eighteen sluice-gates) a small bridge on the Puri road at the entrance of the holy city of Sri Jagannath Deva, He gave vent to His anger at the loss of His staff and in this mood of external indignation proceeded unattended by any one to the Temple of Jagannath asking all His companions to stay behind. Sri Chaitanya made a violent movement to embrace Jagannath the instant He caught sight of Him. This was followed by the manifestation of all the signs of *mahabhava* (superior love) all over His body. Sarvabhauma Bhattacharya who happened to be present in the Temple at the time chanced to notice His condition and intervened to prevent any rough treatment by the *parichhas*. Sarvabhauma was very much struck by the sight of the unique perturbations that were wrought in Sri Chaitanya by holy love and finding that the return of normal consciousness was being delayed had Him conveyed with care to his own residence on the shoulders of men.

(To be continued.)

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 42, July, 1928.)

MEANWHILE Sri Gopinath Acharya Sarbabhauma's sister's husband met Sri Mukunda who was an old acquaintance of his and from him came to learn the tidings of the *sannyas* of Sri Chaitanya and His arrival at Puri. The devotees now heard from the people of the condition of Sri Chaitanya and made their way to the house of Sarbabhauma. From Sarbabhauma's house escorted by Sarbabhauma's son Sri Chandaneswar they proceeded to the temple of Jagannath under Sri Nityananda. The external consciousness of Sri Chaitanya now manifested itself having been in abeyance for over nine hours, after the return of the devotees from their visit to Jagannath. Whom they saw from a distance, Sarbabhauma had by this time been informed about Sri Chaitanya and now arranged for His stay at the house of the husband of his mother's sister.

Sri Gopinath Acharyya having asserted that Sri Chaitanya was God Himself there was a protracted discussion on the subject between himself on one side and Sarbabhauma and his disciples on the other. In course of this discussion Sri Gopinath Acharyya demonstrated to Sarbabhauma that the knowledge regarding God which was self-

manifest could not be attained except through the mercy of God Himself and was unattainable by worldly learning.

When Sarbabhauma next met Sri Chaitanya he asked Him to attend to a course of lectures on the Vedanta which he would deliver for His benefit. As a *Sannyasi*, said Sarbabhauma, it was also the duty of Sri Chaitanya to listen to the Vedanta. Sarbabhauma used to teach the Vedanta even to the *sannyasis* so great was his reputation as a scholar. Sri Chaitanya agreed to Sarbabhauma's proposal and listened to his dissertations for seven days without uttering a single word. On the eighth day Sarbabhauma asking the reason of His continuous silence Sri Chaitanya replied that He understood clearly enough the meaning of the original *sutras* of Vyasa, but the commentary of Shankara which he followed obscured the natural and easy meaning of the *Brahma sutra*; that the commentary of Shankar was really opposed to the Vedanta and was concocted with the deliberate purpose of misleading the atheists; that the position taken up by the Vedanta as to the relation between the *jiva* and God was one of inconceivable simultaneous distinction and identity; and that the illusionists (*mayavadis*) were disguised athe-

is's. Sarbabhauma attempted to defend his own views, but was forced to confess his defeat and to admit the superiority of the arguments of his adversary.

After this discussion Sarbabhauma requested Sri Chaitanya to explain one of the difficult *slokas* of the Bhagabata viz "आत्माराधना" etc. Sri Chaitanya asked Sarbabhauma himself to explain it first. Sarbabhauma made the utmost use of his unparalleled knowledge of the science of polemics to extract out of it nine different meanings. After this Sri Chaitanya without taking a single point from any of those nine varieties gave eighteen different explanations of the same sloka. Sarbabhauma was filled with the greatest admiration and begged for the refuge of the lotus feet of the Supreme Lord. Sri Chaitanya was pleased with Sarbabhauma and manifested to him His four-armed Divine Form and thereafter the two-armed Form also. By this Divine grace the true knowledge manifested itself in Sarbabhauma and he forthwith began to praise Sri Chaitanya in a hymn of a hundred slokas composed improptu. Gopinath and all the devotees were filled with great joy by witnessing this extraordinary mercy of the Lord towards Sarbabhauma.

Shortly after this occurrence early one morning Sri Chaitanya Himself brought the *Pakal prasad* (cooked rice offered to Jagannath and allowed to stand overnight in water) of Sri Jagannath deva and handed it to Sarbabhauma. The Bhattacharya took it immediately although he had not yet performed his morning wash, all his *smarta* scruples having been completely removed by the grace of Sri Chaitanya. Yet another day Sarbabhauma having enquired as to what was the highest method of worship, the Lord told him to chant the holy Name. On another occasion Sarbabhauma, now a most zealous devotee, having suggested to change the reading of one of the *slokas* of the Bhagabata and proposing to substitute in it the word '*bhakti* pade' in place of '*mukti* pade', Sri Chaitanya intervened and said that the *sloka* of the Bhagabata required no change as the word '*mukti* pada' meant 'Sri Krishna'. All the people of Puri were amazed by witnessing the Vaishnava zeal of Sarbabhauma and believed that Sri Chaitanya was really no other than Krishna Himself; and Kashi Misra and many others surrendered themselves, body and soul, at the feet of the Lord.

(To be continued)

are liable to be deluded by another power which also belongs to Krishna and which is called by our scriptures by the name of Maya (*i. e.* by which everything is measured, the principle of limitations). The soul in the pure state is subject to no limitations although it is only a small fraction of the Divine spiritual essence because in the spirit there are no such hard and fast dividing lines enabling it to be measured like material phenomena. This, however,

is also liable to be misunderstood. The human soul is a tiny part of the Divine spiritual essence functioning in the realm of the Absolute which is free from limitations but liable to be expelled from the spiritual world if it ever forgets its own littleness and abjures the guidance of Krishna. So long as it chooses to be guided by Krishna it is free from limitations or ignorance.

(*To be continued*)

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(*Continued from P. 65, August, 1928.*)

THE Supreme Lord having accepted *Sannyas* (renunciation) in the bright fortnight of the month of Magh took up His residence at Nilachal (Puri) in the month of Falgun following. At Puri the Lord witnessed the swing festival of Krishna and delivered Sarbabhauma in the month of Chaitra. He started for the South in Baisakh. The Lord proposed to go alone on His journey but allowed Himself to be persuaded at the special request of Nityananda to take with Him a Brahman, by name Krishnadas, who happened to possess a nature of great simplicity. Sarbabhauma supplied the Lord with four sets of clothing, the lower as well as the outer pieces, worn by an ascetic and requested Him to meet on His way on the bank of the Godavari, Ramananda Rai who was residing there at the time. Nityananda and some of the devotees accompanied the Lord up

to Alalnath. From Alalnath the Lord separated from His companions except Krishnadas and began His memorable journey reciting continuously as He went the word 'Krishna' in a passion of over-whelming love.

On hearing the Name of Hari from the lips of the Supreme Lord all the people of those parts began forthwith to recite the holy Name. Infusing the power of the spirit in all those who threw themselves at His feet the Supreme Lord effected the spiritual conversion of the entire population of the South by means of the disciples of those favoured persons. The glory of the mercy of the Lord manifested itself in the South in even greater measure than at Nabadwip. Moving forward in this manner the Lord arrived at Kurmakshetra. There He accepted the worship of the Kurma-Brahman and bestowing on him His mercy commanded

him to preach the Name of Krishna to others. The Supreme Lord commanded everyone to preach the tidings of Krishna by practising what he was to preach, or, in other words, to become an Acharyya. In the temple of Kurma the Lord showed His mercy to a Brahman of the name of Vasudeva who was afflicted with leprosy of a malignant type, and freeing him at once from the diseases of body and mortality made him an Acharyya. For this act the Lord became known as 'Vasudevamritaprada' (Dispenser of the nectar, or immortality, to Vasudeva).

The Supreme Lord next visited Jior-Nrisingha. At Vidyanagar He met Ramananda Rai by accident on the bank of the Godavari where Rai had come for his daily bath. Rai Ramananda begged the Lord to stop at Vidyanagar for a few days to preach the tidings of Hari. The Lord acceded to his request and stayed for some time at the house of a Vaidic Brahman. When in the evening Rai Ramananda presenting himself before the Lord in the garb of a humble suppliant made his prostrated obeisance the Supreme Lord commanded him to read out a few *slokas* explaining the object (*prayojan*) of spiritual endeavour.

Thereupon Ramananda having briefly referred to the *Varnasrama Dharma* which was followed by all good people, read a number of *slokas* bearing respectively on the offering of all work to

Krishna, on work without worldly attachment, on devotion adulterated with empiric knowledge and lastly on devotion unalloyed with such knowledge. The Lord recognised the last as the true end. He then asked Ramananda to tell him of those subjects that belonged to a still higher stage of endeavour. Rai Ramananda then launched on a memorable discourse taking his topics in the following order of excellence viz. loving devotion in the form of unalloyed attachment for Krishna, love as that of a servant, love as friendship, love as paternal affection and love as embodied in the idea of the lover which last he declared to be the Supreme object of spiritual endeavour. Rai also dilated on the various aspects of amorous love to prove how it constituted the very highest end. The Lord having denied that it was the limit of the end Rai next described the love of Sri Radhika. Rai Ramananda then launched out into a description of the natures of Krishna and Radha and the principles respectively of *rasa* (rapturous quality) and love.

Thereafter in response to the requisition of the Supreme Lord Ramananda Rai recited a song composed by himself which is surcharged with the mood in which the mistress identifies herself with the object of her love in the destruction of separation and which expresses itself in loving activities in keeping with the strong persuasion of such mis-

taken identity with her lover. Lastly the all-important subject of the absolute necessity of loyal submission to the guidance of Sri Radhika's female confidantes of Braja as the means of attaining the highest object of spiritual pupilage viz. the direct loving service of Radha-Krishna, was treated in detail.

After several successive nights had been passed in Krishna discourse the Supreme Lord showed Rai Ramananda His Form as *Shyama* Who reigns supreme over the realm of *rasa* (rapture that melts the soul) and as *Gaura* Who is the highest Love Itself. The sight of the Form Divine caused Rai Ramananda to faint for excessive joy. After a few more days had passed the Lord commanded Rai Ramananda to proceed to Puri giving up his post as an officer of the king and resumed His journey southwards.

Starting from Vidyanagar the Lord visited successively Gautami Ganga, Mallikarjuna, Ahobal Nrishingha, Siddha Bat, Skandha-Kshetra, Trimath, Briddha Kasi, Bauddhasthan, Tripati, Trimalla, Pana-Nrishingha, Siva-Kanchi, Vishnu-Kanchi, Trikalsasti, Briddha-Kol, Siyali-Bhairabi, Bank of Kaveri, Kumbhakarnakapaland arrived at Sri Ranga-Kshetra.

By the mercy of the Supreme Lord attachment for Krishna manifested itself even among elevationists (*Karmis*), salvationists (*jnanis*), worshippers of

Rama, professors of knowledge as end, Sri Vaishnavas and other sects, or in other words, *all* the inhabitants of South India. At Bauddhasthan the supreme Lord refuted the casuistries of the learned Acharyya of the Buddhists. Enraged by his discomfiture the Buddhist teacher laid a plot and caused desecrated food to be offered to the supreme Lord as *mahaprasada*, when a great bird made its appearance and snatched away the impure food together with the dish in which it had been served. The dish then descended on the head of the Buddhist teacher and cut into the skull. The luckless savant was rendered senseless by the violence of the blow. The Buddhists on witnessing the fate of their preceptor at once submitted to the Supreme Lord and by command of the Lord chanting the *Kirtan* of Krishna were turned into Vaishnavas along with their Acharyya. The quondam Buddhist teacher thereupon recited a hymn in praise of the Supreme Lord Whom he recognised as Krishna. The Lord also enabled the Saivas to awake into Vishnavism or consciousness of the real self.

During the four months of *Chatur-mashya* the Lord stayed in Sri Ranga-Kshetra at the house of Venkata Bhatta who was a native of the place and a Vaishnava, being a follower of Sri Ramanujacharyya. The Lord converted Venkata Bhatta with his whole family who had been worshippers of Lakshmi-

Narayana, into devotees of Krishna. The three brothers Tirumalaya Bhatta, Venkata Bhatta and Probodhananda Saraswati obtaining the refuge of the feet of the Supreme Lord attained the eligibility of realising the intoxicating sweetness of Radha-Krishna. Sri Probodhananda Saraswati, the brother of Venkata Bhatta, was an ascetic with the triple staff (*tridandi*). He is uncle and spiritual preceptor of Sri Gopala, Bhatta, son of Sri Venkata Bhatta. During the period of His stay at the house of Venkata Bhatta, Gopala Bhatta had an opportunity of beholding and serving the Lord.

On his arrival at Rishava Parvat from Sri Rangam the Supreme Lord met Sri Paramananda Puri. Puri Goswami then proceeded to Nilachal (Puri). The Supreme Lord started for Rama's Bridge. At South Mathura being touched by the grief of a devotee of Rama the Lord consoled him with the assurance that transcendental Seeta Devi is the mistress of Vaikuntha and is beyond the scope of the polluted touch or sight of the worldly Ravana. Later the Lord procured from Rameswar certain *slokas* of the Kurma Purana that corroborate His statement and showed them to the delighted Brahman. The simple minded Brahman Krishnadas, who accompanied the Supreme Lord, having fallen into the clutches of the Bhattatharis of Malabar the Lord rescued him from his degradation thereby teaching this

lesson as a warning to everybody that the thralldom of the illusory power is the inevitable result of the abuse of one's freedom of will and that this terrible calamity is sure to overtake one who forgets to serve Krishna even for the space of a single moment.

The Lord secured on the bank of the Payaswini river the fifth chapter of the Brahma Samhita, an authoritative work on the principles of the Vaishnava religion. From there He went on to Sringeri Math and Udupi. The Supreme Lord did not esteem the discourses of the then Madhavacharyya of Udupi who was an upholder of the doctrine of knowledge as the end and a supporter of devotion adulterated with empiric knowledge. The Madhavacharyya being afterwards vanquished in controversy recognised the greatness of the Supreme Lord. At Pandarpur the Lord received the tidings of the disappearance of His elder brother, Biswarup, known as Sankararanya, from the lips of Sri Rangapuri. He secured the work 'Krishnakarnamrita' on the bank of the Krishnavenka river. Retracing His steps to Vidyanagar and there once more visiting Rai Ramananda the Supreme Lord returned to Puri by way of Alalnath.

On his return to Puri the Lord took up his residence at the house of Kashi Misra. Sarbabhauma introduced to the Lord all the Vaishnavas who resided at

Sri-Kshetra. Krishnadas was sent to Nabadwip. On learning from Krishnadas the tidings of the Lord's return to Sri-Kshetra the Gaudiya devotees prepared to come up to Puri. Sri Paramananda Puri arrived there by way of Nabadwip bringing with him the Brahman Kamalakanta who was a disciple of Advaitacharyya. Sri Purushottam Bhattacharyya, a native of Nabadwip, after exhibiting the *lila* of accepting *sannyas* from a preceptor of the name of Chaitanyananda at Benares and becoming thereby known under the appellation of Swarup

without assuming the saffron robes now presented himself at the feet of the Supreme Lord at Puri. Govinda who was a disciple of Sri Iswarapuri also made his way to the Supreme Lord after the disappearance of Puri Gossain and in obedience to the command of his preceptor, and was employed in attendance on the person of the Lord. The supreme Lord with great skill made Brahmananda Bharati give up his skin garment. Kashiswar Pandit, disciple of Iswarapuri, also arrived at this time.

(To be continued.)

The Special Characteristics of the Acharyya

[BY PROF. NISHI KANTA SANYAL, M. A.]

(Continued from P. 117, October, 1928.)

IT is not the purpose of Srila Sridhanta Saraswati Thakur to push the prevailing selfishness in the direction of further self-indulgences by the method of sensationalism that quickly evaporates. He is not trying to lead a mass that is characterized by material inertness towards a spell of worldly activities to last for five hundred or a thousand years to the furtherance of the designs of King Discord. He is absolutely free from any such ambitions. On the contrary he is making an effort to found the theistic age that will have no taste for earthly hankerings

of even the subtlest kinds. He has been sending forth in all directions with a voice of thunder the message of the religion of pure devotion of the Srimad Bhagabat which is the complete dedication of the *jiva*-soul to the service of the transcendental Divinity and absolutely free from all duplicity and pre-occupations, in an Age over which King Discord (*Kali*) reigns with un-challenged supremacy, in which the demon of the creed of materialistic work is expecting confidently to swallow up everybody and the demoness Putana of pseudo-liberalism that pretends to

ignore the eternal distinction between spirit and matter is working havoc with spiritual infants, and in which consummate cunning is upheld as the model of sincerity and civic virtue and unbridled license passes under the name of toleration.

This great preacher of the Word of God neglects no method for making his gift available to persons of all degrees, sex and condition. His searching mercy reaches everybody with the sole exception of the scoffers and slanderers of the servants of God,—those who deliberately shut the doors of their houses in the face of the Vaishnavas. With the exception of these enemies of God all persons are being vigorously canvassed by every form of persuasion to listen to the holy Word of God from the lips of *sadhus* and thereby obtain eternal deliverance from the bondage of this unspiritual world. He wants to *force* everybody to listen to the Word of God against one's will where this is practicable. He attracts greedy persons by the lure of delicious dishes to mix in the society of *sadhus*, listen to Hari-Katha from their lips and join in the perambulation of the place where God resides with His own (Sridham). The roaring of the Lion will one day arouse all the sleepers of the world except those who pretend to sleep in order not to hear.

He has carefully graded the worship in accordance with the fitness of the worshipper. For those who are not aware of the potency of the Divinity of the transcendental sound the Acharyya has provided the opportunity of serving God by means of the gross and subtle material bodies by worshipping His holy Image, by perambulation of the Sridham and the performance of various physical activities conducive to the service of Hari, and studies tending to devotion ;—the object being to gradually excite the inclination for the worship of the transcendental sound. For those who belong to the intermediate stage he has provided the opportunity of employment as preacher of the Word of God in order to enable them to realise the body as the temple of God and to bring about the descent of Vasudeva in their pure spiritual essence. While he himself as the best of devotees, in performance of the function of the spiritual preceptor delighting in the society of devotees, is employed in promoting the appearance in all places of the association of devotees which is the transcendental pasturage where Krishna loves to take His rambles and enact His pastimes. His preachings and performances are, therefore, a matter of rejoicing for the whole animate world.

(To be continued)

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 139, November, 1928.)

SARBABHAUMA Bhattacharya having made an attempt to bring about an interview of Maharaj Prataparudra with the Supreme Lord He peremptorily refused to entertain the proposal on the ground that it is contrary to the injunction of the *Shastras* for a *Sannyasi* to look upon the face of worldly people. The Lord in the role of a *Sannyasi* adopted this line of conduct in order to teach the duty of a *Sannyasi* by His own practice. Rai Ramananda came to the Lord at Puri at this time giving up his office in the service of the King. The attitude of the Lord towards the King underwent a change when Rai Ramananda narrated to Him the good qualities of Prataparudra befitting a Vaishnava.

The Supreme Lord betook Himself to Alalnath during the period of *anabhasur* when no one is permitted to have a sight of Sri Jagannathdeva. On His return to Puri from Alalnath the Lord joined Advaita and the other devotees who arrived from Gauda (Bengal). Prataparudra arranged residence and *mahaprasad* for the Gaudiya devotees. In the evening a great congregational *kirtan* was chanted in the Temple of Sri Jagannathdeva by dividing the Vaishnavas into four separate parties

corresponding to the four traditional communities (*Sampradaya*).

The devotees led by Nityananda communicated to the Supreme Lord the great anxiety experienced by Prataparudra for having a sight of the Lord. Lord Nityananda deemed it advisable for the consolation of the King to send him a piece of cloth that had been worn by the Supreme Lord as outer covering. Thereafter as the result of the eagerness of Ramananda the Supreme Lord embraced the King's son who was allowed to approach His person and whom the Lord took to be Krishna. By the touch of his son who was imbued with the divine love the King was enabled to obtain the mercy of the Lord and love for Krishna. On the eve of the Car Festival the Supreme Lord in the company of His devotees manifested the *lila* - of cleansing the *gundicha*. In the midst of the function one of the devotees from Gauda having drunk the water touched by the feet of the Lord He made Swarup Damodar the head of the Gaudiyas to turn him out of the *Gundicha* in order to make it known to all persons as World Teacher that it was an offence in respect of Divine service for a *jiva* to allow his feet

to be washed inside the Temple of God.

The Supreme Lord with His devotees next witnessed the Festivity of Juvenation of Sri Jagannath. As the Lord was engaged in watching the ceremony of Pandu—Vijaya of Sri Jagannath (leaving the Temple preparatory to mounting the Car) He was very much pleased towards Prataparudra on finding the King in the act of performing the humble service of sweeping with a golden broom the pathway over which the cars were to pass. Then Sri Gaursundar formed the party of *kirtan* organised in seven groups and danced in their midst in front of the Car as they chanted the *kirtan* manifesting His Divine powers. When the *kirtan* was concluded as the Lord was resting in a fit of love in the Balagundi Gardens Prataparudra attired as a Vaishnava applied himself to tending the feet of the Lord. On hearing from the King's mouth certain Slokas from the Bhagabat that were in keeping with the occasion the Supreme Lord clasped him in His embrace. The Lord had been softened towards the King by noticing his zealous service of the Vaishnavas and thereafter regarding him no longer as a worldly minded person but as a servant of the Vaishnavas vouchsafed to best His mercy on him.

As Sri Jagannathdeva took up His station at Sundrachal the transcendental activities of Brindaban manifested

themselves to the Supreme Lord. During the festivity of the Nine Nights the Lord stayed in the Jagannathballava Gardens and after He had witnessed the Hera Panchami *lila* on the fifth day thereon sued a prolonged confidential discussion between the Lord. Sribash Pandit and Sri Swarup Damodar regarding the nature of Lakshmi and the milk maids respectively. At the conclusion of the *kirtan* and other devotional activities in connection with the return of the Cars the Supreme Lord commanded Satyaraj Khan and Ramananda Basu of Kulingram to bring with them every year a supply of silken ropes for the Cars.

On the conclusion of the Car Festival Sri Advaita Prabhu worshipped the Supreme Lord with offering of flowers and *tulasi* by the *mantra* 'Whoever Thou art, Thou art He' ('योऽसि सोऽसि') After this on the invitation of Advaita the Lord dined at his place. On the Nandotsab day the Lord with His associates dressed as cowherds indulged in various rejoicings. On the Bejoyadasami day He decked out His devotees in the garb of the army of monkeys while He Himself in the mood of Hanuman gave vent to His great joy. Having witnessed all the other festivals the Lord commanded those devotees who had come from Gauda to return thither. He also despatched Lord Nityananda to Gauda-desa with a party of Vaishnavas consisting of Ramdas,

Das Gadadhar and several others. The Lord commanded Advaita to bestow on all persons down to *chandalas* devotion to Krishna and told Nityananda to preach the message of Divine Love in the country of Gauda without let or hindrance. He then sent clothing etc. which had been offered to Jagannath and many humble greetings per Srivash Pandit to His mother Sri Sachi Devi. He then took his leave of Sri Raghava Pandit, Sri Vasudevadatta Thakur, the devotees of Kulingram and all the Vaishnavas by expatiating on the many good qualities of all.

In reply to the questions of Ramananda and Satyaraj the Supreme Lord laid it down as the function of householder Vaishnavas the duty of serving those Vaishnavas who were well established in chanting the pure Name. Sri Gaursundra thereafter declared the greatness of the Vaishnavas of Khanda and settled their form of service, commanded Sarbabhauma and Vidya-vachaspati to worship Brahman in his watery and wooden forms and after explaining the nature of Murarigupta's devotion to Sri Ramchandra established the conclusion, in conformity with the prayer of Sri Vasudevadatta Thakur which was wholly worthy of a Vaishnava, that Krishna possessed the power of delivering the world with ease.

At the time when the Lord was taking His meal at the house of Sarbabhauma a certain perversion of

judgment having manifested itself in Sarbabhauma's son-in-law Amogh he was attacked with cholera the following morning. The Lord mercifully freed him from the malady and imparted to him attachment for the Name of Krishna.

Sri Advaita and the other Gaudiya devotees were helped by Sivananda Sen to come up to Nilachal in the third year for having a sight of the Supreme Lord. A devoted dog accompanied them on this occasion. The dog disappeared after it had seen the feet of the Lord and honoured the remainder of His tasted food. On this occasion also the Supreme Lord displayed the activities of dancing in front of the car of Jagannath and sweeping the *Gundicha*. He manifested the *lila* of the cow-herds on the eighth day of the dark fortnight, the birth-day of Sri Krishna. In answer to the questions of Satyaraj and other devotees of Kulingram the Lord declared that one who chanted the Name of Hari at intervals is a Vaishnava, one who continuously chanted the holy Name was a Vaishnava of a superior order and the best of Vaishnavas was one the sight of whom made the Name of Hari manifest itself on the lips of beholders.

After the devotees had left the Supreme Lord announced His definite resolve to proceed to Brindaban and He set out on the journey on the Bejoya Dasami day. Ramananda Rai

accompanied the Lord up to Bhadrak. Gadadhar Pandit preferred to follow the Lord in violation of the rules of asceticism which require that an ascetic who has once taken the vow of residing in the holy *tirtha* which happens to be the Abode of the Divinity must not give up the service of continuous and zealous residence in the *tirtha*. The Supreme Lord by a threat of His displeasure sent Pandit Goswami back to Sri Purnshottam from Katak in the company of Sarbabhauma and parted from Ramananda at Bhadrak. Subsequently on reaching the frontiers of the country of Odra He made His way by boat to Panihati escorted by a Mahammedan officer. From Panihati where the Lord put up at the house of Raghava Pandit He made His way to the home of Sribash at Kumarhatta and from there He went to Sivananda's which was not far from the place and thence to the house of Vachaspati at Vidyanagar from where He came secretly to the village of Kulia where He procured the absolution of the offences of Devananda Pandit and Chapal Gopal at the feet of Sribash Pandit.

The modern town of Nabadwip occupies the site of the old Kulia or

Koladwip. For the reason that the Supreme Lord obtained at this place the pardon of those persons guilty of offence against a Vaishnava the locality has ever borne the famous appellation of 'the place of absolution of offence' (अपराध-मञ्जरेर पाठ). Although Devananda Pandit undoubtedly possessed the greatest scholarship, high social position and purity of character and although he was famous as an extraordinarily convincing expounder of the Bhagabat he happened to harbour the pernicious notion that the book Bhagabat was different from the devotee of God who is also called Bhagabat. This led him to offend at the feet of Sribash Pandit and it was for this that one day the Supreme Lord Himself in great anger appeared at the place where Devananda was at the time engaged in expounding the Bhagabat and severely censured him declaring that his reading of the Bhagabat was absolutely useless. At the present day mercenary readers of Bhagabat who appear to be always bent upon offending against the Vaisnavas are unworthy of obtaining the reward of the mercy of the Supreme Lord's punishment.

(To be continued.)

of Love that may be called sublime, supersensuous, high and transcendental. It is something beyond the ken of the ordinary run of human beings. A true Vaishnava is therefore, the much talked of "salt of the earth" or

the "light of the world" and true Vaishnavism is verily the "fulfilment of the law".

BISHWESHWAR DAS, B. A.,

Emeritus Head Master,
Shantipur Municipal H. E. School.

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 184, January, 1929.)

THEN from Kulia-Nabadwip the site of the absolution of offence, the Lord made His way to Ramkeli. At this time Husain Shah was the independent King of Gauda (Bengal). Dabir Khas and Sakar Mallick were the two right-hand men of the King in conducting the government of the country. Dabir Khas and Sakar Mallick became subsequently known as 'Sree Rup' and 'Sree Sanatan' respectively.

Husain Shah was informed by Dabir Khas of the greatness of the Lord and was convinced that the Lord was really the Godhead Himself. The Lord had with Him at Ramkeli Nityananda, Haridasa, Sribasa Gadadhara, Mukunda, Jagadananda, Murari, Bakreshwara and other devotees. The Lord with all His devotees accepted as His own Sri Rupa and Sanatana who are indeed, His eternal servants. In

compliance with the advice of Sanatana giving up for the present His intention of proceeding to Brindabana the Lord returned to Santipur by way of Kanai's Natshala.

The Lord stopped at Santipur for seven days at the house of Advaitacharyya. He consoled His mother who obtained this opportunity of seeing Him a second time and who was sorely stricken with grief at separation from her Son. The Lord also met here Raghunath Das, Son of the famous Gobardhan Das of Saptagram. Sri Raghunath Das is the eternal servant of the Lord. He was at this time pining for an opportunity of joining the Lord by renouncing the world. The Lord, however advised him to conceal his ardour and return to his father's house and there lead a life of detachment from the world the object of the Lord being to teach the people

the difference between superficial and real detachment by his example.

From Santipur the Lord returned to Puri taking with Him Balabhadra Bhattacharyya and Damodar Pandit. After spending a few days at Puri accompanied only by Balabhadra Bhattacharyya the Lord set out for Brindabana and journeyed to Kashi by way of Jharikhanda. While the Lord was making His way through the forest He indulged in the pastime of making the tiger and the deer dance and chant the *Kirtan*.

On His arrival at Benares the Lord bathed in the Manikarnika and after beholding Bishweshwar and Bindu-Madhava in the company of Tapan Misra went to the latter's house and put up there. Raghunath (subsequently Sri Raghunath Bhatta Goswami) the son of Tapan Misra thus obtained an opportunity of tending the feet of the Lord and honouring the remains of His meals. During the four days of His stay at Benares on this occasion Tapan Misra and a certain Marhatta Brahman expressed their great sorrow to the Lord at the unfortunate condition of Benares which was wholly in the grip of illusionism (*mayavada*). They also regretfully informed the Lord of the slanders against Himself which were disseminated by Prakashananda, the leader of the *mayavadi* Sannyasis. The Lord manifested an attitude of indifference towards the activities of this *mayavadi*

mayavadi Sannyasis and having accepted the Marhatta Brahman as His own left for Prayaga.

At the sight of the Yamuna at Prayaga in the excitement of the *Braja lila* the Lord plunged into the water of the stream and was rescued by Balabhadra. The Lord stayed at Prayaga for three days and then proceeded by slow stages towards Mathura along the Mathura road dispensing the Name and love of Krishna.

At Mathura the Lord accepted the alms of food cooked by a Sanoria Brahman who was a disciple of Sri Madhabendra Puri. Sanoria Brahmans lie under the ban of untouchability, have no social standing and all intercourse with them is avoided by other Brahmans. By His action on this occasion the Supreme Lord laid down the principle of the conduct of a Vaishnava.

The Lord visited the different sites of the Brindabana *lila*. The Lord performed the *lila* of chanting the holy Name and instructing the people in regard to the same till midday sitting under the tamard tree of the Age of Krishna that stood near the Chira Ghat. The Lord showed His mercy to Krishnadas, a Rajput who became thenceforward a constant companion of the Lord and His *Kamandulu* bearer. The people got up a rumour to the effect that Krishna Himself had appeared in the Kaliya Lake, mistaking the activities of a fisherman at night. The

simple minded Balabhadra Bhatta-charyya also felt a strong desire of visiting the subject of the false rumour. The Lord removed the error of Balabhadra. By this *lila* the Lord made it clear that it is extremely difficult for a tiny *jiva* to escape the tricks of the illusory power which seeks every opportunity of beguiling the unwary. So great is the power of Maya that a person who happened to be in the very presence of Krishna Himself could be deluded by her into mistaking her trick for Krishna.

Noticing that His stay at Brindabana had the effect of producing excessive loving excitement in the Lord Balabhadra Bhattacharyya deemed it advisable to conduct the Lord back to Prayaga. Having made up their mind to proceed to Prayaga after performing the bath in Ganges at Soro Khetra Krishnadas the Rajput, the Sonaria Brahman of Mathura, Balabhadra Bhattacharyya and a Brahman who had accompanied Balabhadra from the start, set out on the journey with the Lord.

On the way noticing the cows in the act of grazing and hearing the sudden strains of a flute sounded by a cowherd the Lord swooned away due to excitation of the memories of the *Braja lila*. Just at this moment there arrived on the spot a body of ten Pathan horsemen who finding the Lord in an unconscious state and suspecting that His companions had caused the fit for robbing the

Lord of His property, at the instance of their leader, Bijali Khan, the Pathans bound them with chains mentioning their suspicion as the reason of such procedure. As the external consciousness of the Lord returned He had a talk and religious discussion with a Moulana who happened to belong to Bijali Khan's party. The Lord proved from the Koran itself the superiority of devotion to Krishna. Whereupon the Moulana sought the shelter of the feet of the Lord Who after absolving him from his sins bestowed on him the name of Ramdas. Bijali Khan and the other horsemen also surrendered themselves at the feet of the Lord and turned into devotees of Krishna. They were subsequently known as "the Pathan Vaishnabas."

After performing the bath in the Ganges at Soro Kshetra the Lord reached the triple confluence of the rivers at Prayaga. There at Dasasvamedha Ghat the Lord met Sri Rupa who arrived there after enacting the *lila* of renouncing the service of the King and wealth and family. In the meantime Sri Ballabh Bhatta invited and took the Lord to his house at the village of Arial situated on the opposite side of the Yamuna. There the Lord accepted the alms of cooked food. Sri Ballabh Bhatta with all his kindred accepted water touched by the feet of the Lord and worshipped His holy feet. The Supreme Lord introduced Sri Rupa to

Ballabh Bhatta. Subsequently on the arrival of Raghupati Upadhyaya from Tirhoot the Lord had a prolonged mellow conversation with him.

The Lord stopped at Prayaga for ten days at the Dasasvamedha Ghat. Here He secretly infused His power into Sri Rupa and teaching him the principles of amorous devotion in the form of aphorisms commanded him to write "the *Rashamritasindhu*". Then the Lord despatched Sri Rupa to Brindabana and Himself returned to Kashi where He took up His residence at the lodging of Chandra Shekhara.

Sri Sanatana having got rid of his official connection with the King with great skill longing for a sight of the feet of the Lord made his way to Benares and presented himself at the

doorstep of the house of Chandra Sekhara. The Supreme Lord, Knower of all hearts, causing him to be brought from the gateway into the interior of the house commanded him to be made cleanly. After Sanatana had gone through the *lila* of being made *bhadra* he put on *koupin* and *bahirbas* (inner and outer sheets worn by one who has renounced the world) made from a piece of old cloth obtained from Tapana Misra. The answers embodying the substance of all spiritual truth which were given by the Supreme Lord Himself to the questions addressed to Him in the right spirit of enquiry by His eternal servant Sanatana, regarding the nature, duty and object of the *jiva* are known collectively as 'Sri Sanatana Siksha'.

(To be continued.)

The Special Characteristics of the Acharyya

[BY PROF. NISHI KANTA SANYAL, M. A.,]

(Continued from P. 187 January, 1929.)

THE special character of the language of Sri Siddhanta Saraswati Thakur constitutes one of the most remarkable peculiarities of this great Acharyya. Language is fashioned by thought. Language is the external manifestation of the inner mental state. The mind of this Acharyya transcending the tracks of all mundane thought is perennially alit with the mood of

spiritual service radiant with the light of pure cognition and the whole compass of his thoughts wears the fresh charm of the constant endeavour to minister to the pleasure of the senses of Krishna. It is to be expected that the language of such a person should correspond to this unique characteristic of his thought.

Everyone is in a position to realise

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 212, February, 1929.)

WITH the object of delivering the *sannyasis* resident in Kashi who professed the doctrine of illusionism (*mayavad*) the Lord at the request of the devotees by the manifestation of humility and the power of enforcing universal obedience drew unto Himself the hearts of those *sannyasis* and their *guru* Prakasananda assembled at the house of the Marhatta Brahman. Thereafter and in reply to questions addressed to Him by Prakasananda the Lord pointed out all the defects of the view of Sri Sankaracharya by exposing the baselessness of the *mayabad* position and expatiated on the greatness of the holy Name of Krishna. The *sannyasis* of Kashi obtained deliverance by the mercy of the Lord from the all-devouring jaw of the demoness of *mayavad*.

On a certain day at Benares when the Supreme Lord in the company of His devotees began to chant the *kirtan* in the temple of Bindu Madhab, Prakasananda arriving there with his disciples fell down at the feet of the Lord passionately denouncing his own past conduct and enquired about the principle of devotion conformably to the conclusions of the Vedanta. The Supreme Lord after describing the principles of devotion as established in the

Brahma Sampradaya made it known to him that the Srimad Bhagabat offers the only un-ambiguous exposition of the Vedanta philosophy. After this the Supreme Lord sent Sanatan to Brindaban and Himself set out for Nilachal.

Sri Rup Goswami Prabhu arrived at Puri from Brinbaban and stayed with Thakur Haridas. The Supreme Lord freely gave vent to His delight on seeing the famous verses composed by Sri Rup beginning with प्रियः सोऽयं ('the self-same Darling.....'). Another day the Lord listened with great satisfaction to the prefatory and other verses from Sri Rup's dramas 'Lalita Madhab' and 'Bidagdha Madhab'.

In order to establish in the world the ideal of conduct for one who has renounced the world and as a warning to hypocritical psilanthropists the Lord forbade the junior Haridas entry into His house and finally disowned him altogether for the offence of sensuous association with females. The junior Haridas had procured by begging a quantity of raw rice to be used for preparing the Lord's meal, from an aged matron, Madhabi Devi, at the instance of Bhagaban Acharyya who acted the part of the immature devotee. After waiting for a year in the vain hope of

being pardoned the junior Haridas gave up his body in the triple confluence at Prayag. The Supreme Lord on learning this declared that it was the only proper expiation for a pseudo-*Bairagi* who chooses to associate with females.

The fallen *jiva* during the period of spiritual novitiate must not be supposed to be on a level with the *paramahansa* who has attained self-realisation or with the Godhead Himself. In order to make this clear the Lord exhibited the *lila* of sending back Damodar Pandit to Navadwip in consequence of the latter having warned the Lord Himself against unpleasant consequences that might follow His allowing the handsome boy of a youthful Brahman lady to terms of intimacy with Himself.

By the exhibitions of the appearance of the uncouth disease of itching sores all over the body of Sri Sanatan on his arrival at Puri from Mathura and the consequent resolve of Sanatan who was the embodiment of humility to sacrifice his body under the wheels of the Car of Jagannathadeva, as also by explicit declarations to the effect that the transcendental body of Sanatan was the chosen instrument for the fulfilment of the purpose of the Supreme Lord Himself and by such other activities the Lord taught those who are guided by the speculative instinct of their sinful natures that the practice of hollow asceticism is not the method of attain-

ing to Krishna thereby establishing the transcendence of the body of the devotee who makes a complete surrender of himself at the feet of the Lord. The Supreme Lord made Sanatan stay at Sri Kshetra during the year, commanding him to proceed to Sree Brindaban at its close.

When Pradyumna Misra of Srihatta expressed his wish to listen to discourses about Krishna from the lips of the Lord Himself the Supreme Lord directed him to Sri Ramananda. Pradyumna Misra's regard for Rai Ramananda, however, gave way and he returned disappointed on learning the occupation of Rai who in exercise of amorous devotion which is the function of the greatest devotees and *paramahansas*, taught the female attendants at the Temple of Jagannath the art of dramatic performance. The Supreme Lord after explaining Rai's nature which is incomprehensible to fallen souls sent Misra back, for the purpose of being instructed in the principles of the Absolute Truth, to Sri Rai Ramananda, the chanter of the kirtan of Krishna, who although appearing in a family belonging to non-Brahman caste by seminal descent, was the *guru* of all the Brahmans.

The Lord could never tolerate to listen to any propositions opposed to the principle of Truth or charged with the unwholesome quality of sensuous sentimentalism. The Lord consented to

listen only to such books as had undergone a previous and searching examination at the hands of Swarup Damodar as to the author's views regarding principles of devotion and had been passed by him as being worth listening to.

In the state of acutely-felt separation exhibited at Nilachal by the Supreme Lord, Swarup and Ramananda alone ministered to Him.

(To be continued.)

The Special Characteristics of the Acharyya

[BY PROF. NISHI KANTA SANYAL, M. A.,]

(Continued from P. 214 February, 1929.)

THE whole character of this transcendental teacher of the eternal religion to the view of empiric knowledge, wears the terrible aspect of the dreadful club in the hands of the mighty Bhima. No sooner does empiric knowledge make an attempt to flaunt its haughtiness in its presence than it is unceremoniously punished like its prototype Durjodhan by having its thighs broken by the irresistible blows of the pitiless club. Whenever any one intoxicated with the pride of worldly wisdom has endeavoured to gauze the character of this superhuman servant of the transcendental Lord such attempt has invariably recoiled back on itself and broken down hopelessly. Empiric knowledge has been always deceived by its utter incapacity to understand the ideal of the transcendental service of Krishna by all the senses, the unquenchable longing for the service

of the Divinity, the billion-mouthed hunger of the search for Krishna, of this great teacher.

An outstanding characteristic of the Acharyya is his uncompromising repudiation of all association with evil. It is his firm resolve to seek Krishna, the Truth, by discarding, till the last breath of life, all communion with un-truth. It has often seemed to us that the special object of his appearance in this world has been to teach the strictest avoidance of every form of worldliness. His character is the living embodiment of the words of the great seer, 'I will never allow the enemy to enter the holy precincts of the dwelling of the Lord, but ever keep him out of its bounds.' There is absolutely no chance of foisting upon him any plan of pseudo harmony by compromise between what is and is not true. He is wholly opposed to the ideal of the

abnormality of the combination of 'biting the humble straw' and 'plying the dart' methods described in the Chaitanya Bhagabat which is so popular with the present hypocritical generation. He has dug a deep trench which so effectively separates the real from the unreal, the servant of the real from the servant of the unreal, the Vaishnava from the non-Vaishnava, that no one calling himself his follower can pass the same with impunity. It is one of the most striking characteristics of this Acharyya that he effectively maintains the separation of the true from the false by an un-passable distance. He affords every facility to the false to be converted to the Truth but never permits Prolambasur or the jackdaw in peacock's feathers to perform in his dancing halls. Such is the great force of his personality that people of that description, those who are out on the quest of other things than the Truth *viz.* the hypocrites and Prolambasurs, are made quickly to show themselves in their true colours and chased into their proper holes by the mere operation of the power of unalloyed Truth.

Another prominent characteristic of this Acharyya consists in this, that no matter how arrogant or intoxicated with the pride of empiric knowledge or sophistically inclined a person may be and even when such a person confronts

him with all the resources of his arrogance egotism, perversity of judgment, violence and malice he is forced to lower his erect head by being enabled to realise in his heart of hearts the worthlessness of his brittle, counterfeit ware the moment it is in contact with the fire of his divine energy. Among such persons those who are hypocritical, despite their unwillingness to confess their inferiority, are betrayed by their pale faces which bear tell-tale testimony to their actual condition.

Another distinctive characteristic of this great teacher is his desire to make a gift of the full Truth to all. As the living embodiment of the proposition 'he beheld the Divine Person in His fullness with the deluding power relegated to an obscure corner' he detects the overt presence of Maya in everything that is not full or has an appearance of being part of the whole. Wherefore being bent upon making a gift of the full substantive Truth he always preaches to all persons without distinction the tidings of the complete service of Hari. He is not satisfied by any specious propositions of partial service. He preaches to everybody the all-time service of the Divinity. He tells everyone to open without the least reservation one's full receptive faculty for receiving the full gift. He directs everybody to offer one's all at the lotus feet of Krishna.

(To be continued.)

mahaprasad. 'If the palate is conquered every other sense is conquered.' We can never be freed from the attraction of sensuous temptations until we give up eating altogether and learn to honour the *mahaprasad*. By honouring the *mahaprasad* our sensuousness is diminished and ultimately disappears altogether and it is only then that we are enabled to understand the real meaning of the *shastras*.

The *sadhu* helps the fallen *jiva* to regain his natural state of freedom from sin and constant service of the Lord by bringing about *descent* of the transcendental sound in the form of words uttered by his lips and the *mahaprasad* in the shape of food that is offered by him to the Lord. The sound uttered

by the *sadhu* and the *mahaprasad* are not things of this world. They are not identical with ordinary sound or ordinary food which are only means for the gratification of our sensuous inclinations and appetites. The Word of God and *mahaprasad* cannot be enjoyed or in other words cannot be used for the gratification of the senses, because they are spiritual. Those who enjoy the *kirtan* or any spiritual discourse or eat the *mahaprasad* for appeasing hunger or gratification of the palate are guilty of sacrilegious acts which serve only to prolong the state of sin and ignorance of the greatest possible calamity that can befall the human soul.

The Supreme Lord Sri Krishna-Chaitanya

(Continued from P. 237, March, 1929.)

AT this time on the arrival of Sree Raghunath Das at Purusottam the Lord committed him to the charge of Sri Swarup Goswami after bestowing on him the appellation of 'Swarup's Raghu'. In recognition of the state of Raghunath, the best-beloved of the Lord, as the Guru of all the Brahmans, the Supreme Lord made over to him for the purpose of worship the holy Images of the Holder of the Mount and

of Gandarbha, in the forms of a piece of stone from Gobardhan and the garland of *gunja* plant, that He used to worship Himself. Sri Raghunath honoured the rejected rotten remains of the *prasad* of Jagannath washing off the mud with which the rice had got mixed up. Swarup and the Supreme Lord were satisfied with the spirit of renunciation displayed by Raghunath and one day tasted the same

food by forcibly snatching it from him.

Sri Ballav Bhatta arrived at Puri on the occasion of the Car Festival and availed of the opportunity to greet the feet of the Supreme Lord. With the object of lessening the vanity of Ballav the Lord extolled the high qualities of His own devotees which He declared to be superior to his. Sri Ballav Bhatta had written an annotation of the Bhagabat to rival the commentary of Sridharswami. On preferring his request to the Lord that He would be pleased to listen to his annotation the Lord remarked that one who did not acknowledge her husband (punning on the word '*swami*') was thereby proved to be a harlot and declared that the real meaning of the Name Krishna is 'the Beautiful Shyam, the Darling of Yasoda'. Subsequently the Lord became favourably disposed towards Ballav and accepting his invitation to dinner commanded him to learn the meaning of the *mantra* from Gadadhar.

Ramchandra Puri who professed himself to be a devotee of Madhabendra Puri had been repudiated by him for offending at the lotus feet of Sri Gurudeva by self-assertiveness. Ramchandra Puri mistaking the Lord to be a sinful *jiva* maliciously objected to His accepting a liberal quantity of food. The Lord remained silent under the

criticism but cut down His diet. By this *lila* the Supreme Lord furnished a terrible example of how as the result of disobedient conduct of one who professes to be the disciple of a good preceptor who is the best of devotees, the offence against the Guru by degrees touches the Divinity Himself. By this act the Lord sternly denounced the principles of the psilanthropists who suppose that there is no difference between a novice and one who has realised his proper self, or between a *jiva* and Godhead.

Gopinath Pattanaik, a son of Bhabananda Rai, having washed the royal treasure, the eldest son of Maharaja Prataparudra caused Gopinath to be lifted to the raised platform for the execution of criminals in order to award the punishment due to such grave offence. Whereupon the Lord on being approached by all with a request to intervene in order to prevent the punishment of Gopinath, at first refused to save him expressing His resolve to eschew all worldly talk and the society of worldly people to teach the proper conduct of a Vaishnava *sannyasi*; but subsequently effecting the deliverance of Gopinath taught him the principles of moral obligation by advising him to perform his duties to the King and meet his own expenses by earning money in a clean way.

(To be continued.)

The Supreme Lord Sree Krishna Chaitanya.

(Continued from P. 259, April 1929.)

ONE day the Supreme Lord having taken His meal after a short rest on the conclusion of *Kirtan* laid Himself down alongside the entrance to His sleeping chamber. Govinda who used to attend on the person of the Lord at the time when He retired to bed finding the Lord lying against the door, spread the piece of cloth worn by him as outer covering over the body of the Lord and in that manner crossed over to the inside of the chamber and engaged in tending the feet of the Lord.

Considering it a grave offence to come out of the room for his own meal by crossing the body of the Lord a second time and minding specially the excessive exertion in *Kirtan* of that day of the Lord, Govinda continued tending the Lord's person delaying to take his food. After exhibiting the pastime of awaking from sleep the Lord asked Govinda the reason for having stayed there without food up till then. Although the Lord Himself demanded to know, Govinda without mentioning at all that he had been employed in tending His person simply replied that he had not crossed the body of the Lord through fear of committing offence. By means of this conduct of Govinda, the Supreme Lord

made manifest to the world the ideal of the devotee who is free from all guile. The gratification of the senses of Krishna is the only object that the ideal devotee has in view. The pure devotee has a repugnance for and an apprehension of offence by the least lurking wish for the gratification of his own senses in promoting the gratification of the senses of Krishna. The food that has already been offered to the Supreme Lord is part and parcel of the Supreme essence and such food is honoured by the devotee by reason of its connection with the Lord. But the sincere devotee is afraid of being guilty of desiring the gratification of his own senses in the performance of the service of honouring Mahaprasad as it happens to be apparently a personal affair. The devotee who is free from guile is never anxious to advertise his devotion to the Lord by proclaiming the tidings of his own services to the object of service. The Supreme Lord taught these principles by means of the conduct of that eternal devotee of Guru, Sree Govinda. Govinda used with great care to make the Lord partake of the numerous varieties of basketfuls of delicacies supplied regularly by Raghav Pandit and Damayanti.

Thakur Haridas left this world in the act of beholding the Lord and chanting His Name. The Supreme Lord taking up the transcendental body of Haridas into His own holy arms, chanted the *Kirtan* and danced in the company of His devotees. The Lord then conveyed Thakur Haridas, accompanied by the congregational chant of *Kirtan*, to the sea-shore and bathed his body in the sea, and, having washed the feet of Haridas, made the devotees drink the water purified by the touch of his feet. Thereafter the Supreme Lord placed Haridas into his final resting place covering him with sand with His own hand, the function being preceded by the congregational chanting of *Kirtan*. The Supreme Lord caused a memorial to be built over his resting place. The Lord having Himself begged alms from the shop-keepers at the Lion-Gate of the Temple of Sri Sri Jagannath Deva celebrated the festivity of his disappearance with great pomp to the accompaniment of singing the glories of Haridas.

During one of these years, after the arrival of the Gaudiya devotees at Puri, Parameswar Modak of Sree Mayapur, introducing himself as the person who supplied the Lord during His *lila* as a child with milk-puddings etc., informed him that his wife had come with himself to Puri. The Lord exhibiting the *lila* of a Sannyasi who is Guru of the whole world and Teacher

of the people, displayed the ideal of experiencing a sense of hesitancy on hearing the mention of the name of a woman, although in this case the lady in question happened to be of the age of His mother. Sri Jagadananda having procured with great care a pitcherful of sweet-scented *Chandanali* oil from the home of Sree Sivananda Sen presented the same for the use of the Supreme Lord. The Lord exhibiting the *lila* of Teacher of the people said that the oil might be used for lighting the lamp of Sree Sree Jagannath Deva. It is not proper for a Sannyasi to anoint himself. On hearing this Pandit Jagadananda in a fit of loving pique broke to pieces the vessel containing the oil in the view of the Lord and having bolted the door of his own room lay down without tasting any food. On the third day the Lord, Who is subdued by the love of His devotees, with the object of breaking the mood of loving estrangement of His devotee, proceeding to the house of Jagadananda and persuading the Pandit as a personal favour to Himself to cook with his own hand, accepted the food prepared by him and made the Pandit honour the *prasad*. By means of this *lila* the Supreme Lord, enacting the pastime of Teacher of the people, impressed upon all the duty of passionately loving service of the Lord, Who is the sole Enjoyer of every thing, by means of the very best

offerings and taught that it is a duty of the spiritual novice to avoid all sensuous enjoyment and cultivate the practice of detachment from the world.

Aware of the fact that the Supreme Lord experienced great discomfort for having to lie on a mat made of bands stripped off plantain bark Jagadananda having prepared quilt, pillow etc., the Supreme Lord did not accept them. Sri Swarup Goswami Prabhu having made strips of plantain bark into likenesses of quilt and pillow and offering the same to Him, the Supreme Lord accepted them after much objection. By means of this *lila* the Lord warned those Sannyasis who were in the stage of neophytes. On hearing the sound of song of Gitagobinda from the lips of female attendants at the temple of the Supreme Lord, in the state of semi-external consciousness, forgetting Himself under the influence of love was making headlong towards a female attendant through wild growths of prickly plants, and Gobinda having intervened, the Lord on hearing the word 'woman' uttered by Gobinda thanked him very much. By this *lila* the Lord forbade by all means the opinions held by psilanthropists under the pretext of an attempt to listen to Krishna-song from the lips of unknown females, on the part of a Sannyasi or Vaishnaba. When Sri Raghunath Bhatta came to Purushottama from Kashi he brought with him a certain Pandit of the name

of Ramdas Biswas, belonging to the community of Ramananda. The Lord showed indifference towards Ramdas who cherished in his heart the desire for salvation and vanity of learning although enacting outward humility and an aptitude for serving Vaishnabas. Having forbidden Raghunath Bhatta to marry, the Lord sent him back to Kashi for the service of the Vaishnabas.

One day the Lord standing near the Garuda pillar in the temple of Sri Jagannathdeva, was engaged in beholding the Holy Figure of Jagannath. A certain aged Oriya woman putting her feet unconsciously on the shoulder of the Lord, was gazing at Jagannath with great eagerness. Gobinda having made the woman alight, the Lord manifested great love while praising the earnestness of the woman. One day the Lord manifested the *lila* of lying down in the inner chamber at night bolting all its three doors. After a short while Gobinda and Swarup saw that all the doors remained bolted but the Lord had disappeared. Seeing this Swarup and the other devotees began to search and found the Lord to the north of the Lion-gate in an unconscious state, His body greatly enlarged on account of relaxation of the joints of the bones. The Lord regaining His consciousness as the result of the chanting of the Name of Krishna by the devotees they brought Him back to His chamber.

On another occasion while the Supreme Lord was moving fast towards sandhills considering them to be Gobardhan Mount perturbations reducing Him to the fixed condition of a marble pillar and a wonderful state due to the presence of the highest love illustrated by horripillation and other signs which made Him look like the Kadamba flower were manifested to the view of the devotees.

The Lord descending to the external state by the loud chanting of the Name of Hari by Gobinda and other devotees was thereupon conducted by them to His residence.

Under the influence of great love the Supreme Lord used to give vent to His lamentations clasping the necks of Swarup and Ramananda, in the mood of handmaid of Gopi and, entering the garden of flowers considering it to be Brindaban, would enquire about Krishna from all the trees, creepers, shrubs and animals.

By bestowing on Kalidas, who fed on the leavings of the meals of Jharuthakur who made his appearance in a family of scavengers, the mercy of permission of drinking water touched by His own feet the Supreme Lord did away with the objection to honour the leavings of the meal of a Vaishnava on the ground of birth and proclaimed the infinite power of Mahaprasad in helping the spiritual novice to success. Paramanandapuridas, the seven year old

son of Shivananda, came to the Supreme Lord, obtained the Mahamantra of the Name of Hari and gave proofs of his transcendental poetical power.

One day in the midst of diverse activities of delirium due to love the Lord was discovered at midnight lying in the form of a tortoise in the midst of Tailangi cows having crossed to the place over three separate lines of walls without opening the gates.

Another day on a moonlit night the Lord beholding the sea from Aitota jumped into it considering it to be the Jamuna. A certain fisherman taking Him to be a large fish dragged the Lord ashore in an unconscious state by means of his fishing net. The fisherman was overpowered by love as soon as he touched the Lord. The fisherman suspected that he was possessed with an evil spirit and was going in search of an exorciser when he was found in that condition by the devotees led by Sree Swarup Goswami who were coming along the sea-shore after having searched for the Lord at different places by different methods. Being informed of the fact that the very fisherman had raised the Supreme Lord from the sea the devotees made their way to the place where the Lord lay and having slowly brought Him back to the external state by means of loud Kirtan of the Name and having learnt from the Lord's own

holy mouth the narrative of His great love brought Him back to His house.

On one occasion Sri Jagadananda brought from Sri Nabadwip a certain riddle in rhyme composed by Sri Advaita Acharya. After reading it the mood of separation of the Supreme Lord increased in intensity. The confidential devotees were enabled to understand that the Supreme Lord would shortly manifest the *lila* of disappearance. In the delirium of separation the Lord began to exhibit the *lila* of divine madness in the form of rubbing the face against the wall of the sanctum. One day in the garden of Jagannath Ballav under the over-powering influence of great love He manifested ten varieties of speaking strange gossip. Sometimes the Lord passed the night tasting the octade of teachings composed by Himself in the company of Sri Swarup and Ramananda in the mood of anxious concern in the forms of humility, apprehension etc.; or again sometimes the ocean of deep love of separation welled up in ever-new forms

as the result of tasting the verses of Sri Geeta Gobinda, Sri Karnamrita, the drama of Sri Jagannath Ballav, Srimad Bhagabata, etc.

In this manner the Supreme Lord manifested the first part of His Divine activities by enacting during the first twenty-four years of His life the *lila* of a householder. During the concluding twenty-four years of His career the first six years were employed in preaching pure devotion over all India as crest-jewel of Sannyasis enacting the *lila* of Acharya. Of the closing eighteen years the first six were occupied by the activities as Acharya resident at Puri, in the company of His devotees; and the last twelve years were passed in tasting constantly the mellow quality of transcendence in association with His intimate devotees. After elaborating the *lila* of His appearance for forty-eight years the Lord manifested the *lila* of disappearance by means of His own power of voluntary withdrawal from the view of the people of this world.

